

Born Again

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一、重生是甚么意思？

「耶稣回答说：我实实在在的告诉你，人若不重生，就不能见神的国。」
(约 3:3)

「耶稣说：我实实在在的告诉你，人若不是从水和圣灵生的，就不能进神的国。」(约 3:5)

「重生」是甚么意思呢？「重」就是「再」的意思。一个人以前作过一件事，现在他再作，我们就说「重作」。比方说一个人在若干年前曾到过某个地方，现在他又来到这个地方，我们就说他「旧地重游」。「生」这一个字在中文有许多的意思，就如「生产」、「生长」、「生命」、「生存」等等，但这里所说的「生」，乃是「生产」的意思。那样，我们把「重生」这两个字放在一处，就是「再生产一次」。每一个人都曾经过第一次的生产。当他乍出母腹，呱呱落地的时候，那是第一次

1. What is Born Again?

“I tell you the truth, no-one can see the Kingdom of God unless he is Born Again.” (John 3:3)

“Jesus answered, ‘I tell you the truth, no-one can enter the Kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit.’” (John 3:5)

What is ‘Born Again’? ‘Again’ means *Once More*. Someone did something before, he does it again now, it is what we say *Redo*. If one visited a place years ago, and pays a visit to that place now, it is what we say *To Revisit Old Haunts*. ‘Born’ bears various meanings in Chinese, like production, growth, life, living etc. The ‘Born’ here is *Birth*. If we put these two Chinese words 重生 together, it means *Born Again*. Everyone came across the first being born. When one leaves one’s mother’s womb cryingly, it is one’s first being born. No-one can enter this world to become a human, until one has come across this first being born. If one has to enter the

的生产。每一个人都必须经过这第一次的生产，然后方能进入这个世界，方能成为一个人。但他要进入神的国，要成为神的孩子，却非经过第二次的生产不可。因为主耶稣的话明明说：「我实实在在的告诉你，人若不重生，就不能见神的国。」

必有人在听见这话以后要十分惊异的问道：「人怎能再生产一次呢？这样大的一个人还能回到母腹中再生一次么？」人问这样的问题是不足为奇的，当日与耶稣谈话的尼哥底母听见耶稣讲论重生的道理，也曾问过这个问题说：「人已经老了，如何能重生呢？岂能再进母腹生出来么？」「重生」的道理本是我们从来未曾想到的，乃是神的一个大奥秘，若非主耶稣清清楚楚的解明，无论甚么人听见「重生」这句话都不能不感觉落在五里雾中一样。

主耶稣怎样回答尼哥底母这个问题呢？说：「我实实在在的告诉你，

Kingdom of God and become a child of God, one has to come across the second giving birth. Since Lord Jesus says explicitly that "I tell you the truth, no-one can see the Kingdom of God unless he is Born Again."

Those who heard this must ask surprisingly, "How can a man be Born Again? Surely he cannot enter a second time into his mother's womb to be born!" Asking this kind of question is not surprising at all. When Nicodemus heard what Jesus talked about the idea of Born Again, he asked, "How can a man be born when he is old? Surely he cannot enter again into his mother's womb to be born!" We don't know the truth of Born Again, it is God's great secret. If not for Lord Jesus giving the explanation distinctly, whoever hears the Words of Born Again could not help to be utterly mystified.

How did Lord Jesus answer Nicodemus' enquiry? He said, "I tell you the truth, no-one can enter the

人若不是从水和圣灵生的，就不能进神的国。从肉身生的就是肉身；从灵生的就是灵。我说『你们必须重生』，你不要以为希奇。风随着意思吹，你听见风的响声，却不晓得从哪里来，往哪里去；凡从圣灵生的，也是如此。』(约 3:5-8) 祂叫尼哥底母知道，重生并不是进到母腹中，然后从母腹中再生产一次。这样的生产纵使再有几十次、几百次，仍是毫无补益，因为「从肉身生的就是肉身」。重生不是从肉身生，乃是从「水和圣灵」生。

这里所说的水不是物质的水，乃是指着神的道。我们都知道一切有生命的物都不能离了水；照这样，属灵的生命也不能离了神的道。我们又知道，水能洁净一切污秽的东西；照这样，神的道也能洁净我们心身一切的污秽。圣经中用水代表神的道真是最合宜的（参弗 5:25-27；约 15:3）。圣经中又有两段说话清清楚楚的告诉我们，

Kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit. Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit. You should not be surprised at my saying 'You must be Born Again.' The wind blows wherever it pleases. You hear its sound, but you cannot tell where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit." (John 3:5-8) He told Nicodemus that being Born Again was not re-entering one's mother's womb. Even having this kind of being born for hundreds of times, it makes no difference. Flesh gives birth to flesh, Born Again is not born of flesh, but of water and the Spirit.

The water mentioned here is not the tangible one, but Words of God. We all know that no life can live without water. Likewise, lives of spirit cannot go without Words of God. Water can cleanse everything filthy. Likewise, the Words of God can wash away our physical and mental impurity. The Words of God as represented by Water in the Bible is most suitable. (See Ephesians 5:25-27; John 15:3) Two passages in the Bible tell us

这里所说的水是指着神的道：

「我亲爱的弟兄们，不要看错了。各样美善的恩赐和各样全备的赏赐都是从上头来的，从众光之父那里降下来的；在并没有改变，也没有转动的影儿。祂按自己的旨意，用真道生了我们，叫我们在所造的万物中好像初熟的果子。」(雅 1:16-18)

「你们蒙了重生，不是由于能坏的种子，乃是由于不能坏的种子，是藉着神活泼常存的道。因为凡有血气的，尽都如草；他的美荣都像草上的花。草必枯干，花必凋谢；惟有主的道是永存的。所传给你们的福音就是这道。」(彼前 1:23-25)

第一次的生产是从肉身生的。肉身是污秽的、必朽坏的，所以凡从肉身生的也是污秽的、必朽坏的；第二次的生产是从神的道和神的灵生的。神的道和神的灵是圣洁的，是不朽坏的，所以凡从水和圣灵生的也是圣洁的、不朽坏的。「从肉身生的就是

clearly that the Water here is the Words of God.

“Don’t be deceived, my dear brothers. Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of the heavenly lights, who does not change like shifting shadows. He chose to give us birth through the *Word of Truth*, that we might be a kind of first fruits of all He created.” (James 1:16-18)

“For you have been Born Again, not of perishable seed, but of imperishable, through the living and enduring *Word of God*. For, ‘All men are like grass, and all their glory is like the flowers of the field; the grass withers and the flowers fall, but the *Word of the Lord* stands for ever.’” (1 Peter 1:23-25)

The first giving birth is of flesh. Flesh is filthy and mortal, so that those born of flesh are filthy and mortal. The second giving birth is of the Words of God and the Spirit of God. The Words of God and the Spirit of God are sacred and immortal, so that whoever born of water and Spirit are sacred and immortal. Flesh gives birth to flesh,

肉身；从灵生的就是灵。」

有人说：「重生这种说法并不是说真有一次生产的事实，不过是一个比喻，表明一个人悔悟以前的罪恶，决定心志要作一个好人，并且他真能洗心革面，痛改前非，这种心志和行为正好像一个人又重新生产了一次一样。先哲所说：『从前种种譬如昨日死，以后种种譬如今日生』，也就是这个意思。」

说这种话的人明显有两个极大的错误：第一，他们擅自更改了主耶稣所讲的话。主耶稣未曾说重生是个比喻。祂以第二次的生产为一件事实，如同第一次的生产是一件事实一样。如果我们以第二次的生产为一个比喻，那样第一次的生产也必是一个比喻了。请问这样的说法通不通呢？

假如有人告诉你说，你的一个朋友在昨天晚间生了一个儿子，你便问她说：「这是一个比喻呢，还是一件事实呢？」你想这个问题是何等没有理性，何等可笑呢？再比方

but the Spirit gives birth to spirit.

Some say, "Being Born Again isn't a realistic giving birth, but a metaphor of one's sorry for former sins, and resolve to be good, making a thorough reformation, correcting one's faults. This kind of will and action looks like being Born Again, with the same meaning as suggested by some sages, 'Whatever happened passed away like yesterday; whatever happen after lives like today.'"

Those who say this make two serious mistakes. First, they take it upon themselves to change the Words of Lord Jesus. Lord Jesus has never said Born Again is a metaphor. He regards the second birth a matter of fact as if the first one. If we look upon the second birth as a metaphor, then the first one must be a metaphor too. Does this way of argument justify?

If someone tells that one of your friends had a son born last night, you ask her, "Is it a metaphor or a fact?" What an irrational and silly question it is to you! As another analogy, you told someone your personal details, telling when

说有一次你向人述说你的履历，你说你在某年某月某日生在某某地方。听见的人便向你发问说：「那是一个比喻呢，还是一件事实呢？」请问你要怎样回答这个问题呢？你一定要哂笑那个发问题的人，说他是患神经病的。好了，你既承认第一次的生产是一件事实，怎么能说第二次的生产是一个比喻呢？

说这种话的人的第二个错误，就是他们完全弄错了「生」的意思。一个小孩子生出来，乃是被他的父母所生。他不能生他自己。这样，一个人被重生也是如此，他是被神所生，他完全是处于被动的地位。若照上面所提的那种说法，说一个人洗心革面，痛改前非就是重生，那便是说他重生了自己。我们走遍天涯地角也不会找出「一个人生他自己」这种怪事来。不错，一个人必须痛心悔改，信靠耶稣，才能得重生。但我们当知道那是得重生的条件。一个人履行这个条件，神方能藉着道和圣灵生

and where you were born. The hearer then asked, "Is it a metaphor or a fact?" How should you answer such question? You will tease the one who made such a question, regarding him mentally disordered. Well, having recognized that the first birth is a fact, why do you allege that the second birth is a metaphor?

Their second mistake is that they misunderstand completely the meaning of *Birth*. A child's birth is done by the parents, one cannot give birth oneself. Therefore, one's Born Again is the same, one, being born from God, is in a passive situation. According to the above illustration, if someone felt sorry for the former sins, and really made a thorough reformation, correcting one's faults, then we say one did his own Born Again. It is ridiculous to find anyone who did one's own Born Again around the world. It is true to say that in order to be Born Again, one has to repent bitterly, have faith in Jesus. However those are the conditions of being Born Again. God can make

他。痛心悔改这件事是我们作的，重生我们这件事乃是神作的。若说痛心悔改方能得重生，这话是对的。若说痛心悔改就是重生，这话便全盘错误了。

必有人说，我们承认第一次的生产是一件事实，因为我们看见了那件事实。我们看见一个产妇在产房里生育，又看见一个几磅重的婴儿呱呱落地；但我们从来未曾看见过一个人怎样得重生，也未曾看见过从水和圣灵生的那个人。没有看见过的事怎能说是事实呢？

真的么？没有看见过的事便不能是事实么？我们中间有谁看见过神呢？有谁看见过主耶稣呢？有谁看见过圣灵呢？有谁看见过天使呢？又有谁看见过魔鬼呢？我们虽然未曾看见过神，但仍确信有神；虽然未曾看见过主耶稣，却仍信有耶稣；虽然未曾看见过圣灵，却仍信有圣灵；虽然未曾看见过天使

one born of the Words and Spirit, only if the conditions are fulfilled. Repenting bitterly is done by us, while making us Born Again is God's job. Saying that repenting bitterly can make us Born Again is correct. It is absolutely erroneous to say that repenting bitterly is Born Again itself.

It must be said that the first birth should be recognized as a fact, since it can be seen. The baby born in the delivery room by the pregnant woman can be seen, but never has a case of Born Again been seen. Never has one born of water and Spirit been seen. How can something which cannot be seen be fact?

Is that so? Is it impossible that something which cannot be seen cannot be fact? Who of us has ever seen God? Who has seen Lord Jesus? Who has seen Holy Spirit? Who has seen angels? Who has seen the Devil? Although we have not yet seen God, we still believe in God. Although we have not yet seen Lord Jesus, we still believe in Jesus. Although we have not yet seen Holy Spirit, we still believe in Holy Spirit. Although we have not

与魔鬼，却仍信有天使与魔鬼；就是因为这些都是属于灵界的。物质界有许多的事实，灵界也有许多的事实。不过因为我们现今处在物质界内，我们的身体和眼睛也都是属于物质界的，所以不能看见灵界的事实。圣灵是确实有的，一个人从水和圣灵生也是一件真确的事实，不过这都是我们属物质的眼睛所不能看见的罢了。

又有人要问说，重生既是一件事实，那样必定有一个新生出来的人了，但是那个人在哪里呢？我们要回答这个问题：「是，实在有一个新生出来的人；圣经中称这个人为『里面的人』，同时称那第一次所生的人为『外面的人』。」容我们读经上的话：「所以，我们不丧胆。外体虽然毁坏，内心却一天新似一天。」(林后 4:16)

这一节经文在中文的译本里有两个错误：第一，这一节经文的希腊原文有一个「人」字，中文的译本却把它译作「体」

yet seen angels and the devils, we are sure there are angels and the devils. Since they all are of spiritual. In the material world there are many facts, and so is the spiritual world. In the material world now, our bodies and eyes of the material world cannot see those in the spiritual world. Surely there is Holy Spirit, one born of water and Spirit is also a fact absolutely true, somehow they cannot be seen by materialistic eyes.

Someone will ask, "If Born Again is a fact, there should be one who was Born Again. Where is he?" Our response is, "Yes, there surely is one who was Born Again. The Bible calls it 'the Inward Man', while that of the first born is 'the Outward Man'. Let's read, "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though outwardly we are wasting away, yet inwardly we are being renewed day by day." (2 Corinthians 4:16)

There are two mistakes in the translation of this verse. First, there should be a 'man' in the Greek text, we have the translation in Chinese as a 'body'. Second, in the

字；第二，中文的译本加了一个「心」字，是原文里所没有的。这一节经文在原文是说：「所以，我们不丧胆。我们外面的人虽然毁坏，里面却一天新似一天。」前一句说「外面的人」，后一句是说「里面的」。后一句虽然没有「人」字，但对照上面的意思，也可以清楚看出它的意思是说「里面的人」。所以英文的译本就在后一句当中「里面的」以后加上一个「人」字，在这一节中我们清楚看出信徒的两个人：一个是「外面的人」，是从肉体生的，是显于外的、看得见的；一个是「里面的人」，他是从灵生的，是隐于内的、看不见的。可惜在中文的圣经译本里竟把这「外面的人」译作「外体」；又把这「里面的人」译作「内心」，以致这一节中很重要的一样真理竟被掩藏起来。

除去以上所提的一节经文以外，还有两处经文提到这「里面的人」，可惜这两处经文在中文的译本里也都没有按着原文的意

Chinese translation, a word 'heart' is added. Originally the verse reads: "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our *outward man* is wasting away, yet *the inward* is renewed day by day." We have 'outward man' in the first part and 'inward' the second. Though we do not have the word 'man' in the second part, we do see the distinct meaning of 'the inward man', as added in the English Version. In this verse we find distinctly two persons in the believer: the 'outward man' who was born of the flesh, can be seen explicitly; and the other 'inward man' who was born of the Spirit, it is spiritual and cannot be seen. It is a pity that the Chinese translation made the 'outward man' an external body and the 'inward man' the 'internal heart', making the significant truth of the verse concealed.

Other than the verse we have mentioned, there are two more verses consisting this 'inward man'. However the translations are not made correctly. The one in Romans

思译出来。其中一段经文是罗 7:22，这一节中「里面的人」在中文译本译作「里面的意思」；另一段是弗 3:16，这一节中「里面的人」在中文译本译作「心里的力量」。其实「内心」、「里面的意思」和「心里的力量」这几个名词在原文都是「里面的人」。这「里面的人」是神所生的，所以他「喜欢神的律」(罗 7:22)。他与那「外面的人」是绝不相同的，所以「外面的人」虽然因为经过种种苦楚患难而渐渐毁坏，「里面的人」却因此一天新似一天(林后 4:16)。但这「里面的人」也能因着种种原因变为刚强或软弱，所以使徒求神「按着祂丰盛的荣耀，藉着祂的灵」，使信徒「里面的人刚强起来」。(弗 3:16)

7:22, the 'inward man' is translated as 'the inner meaning', while the one in Ephesians 3:16, the 'inward man' is translated as 'the force of the heart'. As a matter of fact, the 'inner heart', the 'inner meaning', and the 'force of the heart' all are the 'inward man' in the original text. This 'inward man' is born of God, so he 'delights in God's law' (Romans 7:22). He is greatly different from the 'outward man', though so many distresses and adversities waste the 'outward man' away, yet the 'inward man' is being renewed day by day. (2 Corinthians 4:16) The becoming weak or strong of the 'inward man' has various reasons, so the Apostle prays that out of God's glorious riches He may strengthen believers' 'inward men'. (Ephesians 3:16)

二、为甚么人必须重生？

「我说你们必须重生，你不要以为希奇。」(约 3:7)

我们当注意主耶稣在这里所说的一句话：「你们

2. Why must man be Born Again?

“You should not be surprised at my saying ‘You must be Born Again.’” (John 3:7)

We should notice Lord Jesus' Words: You must be Born Again.

必须重生」。重生不是一件可有可无的事，也不是一件无关紧要的事。它是「必须」的事——要见神的国「必须重生」；要进神的国「必须重生」；要到神面前来「必须重生」；要作神的儿子「必须重生」。

可惜多少称为基督徒的人轻忽了这事！多少称为传福音的人也轻忽了这事！他们看重「考道」，看重「记名」，看重「受洗」，看重「坚振」，以为这些都是「必须」的。以为一个人经过这些步骤以后便可以蒙神的悦纳，进神的国；却将耶稣所看为重要，并且要我们也看为重要的事看为无足轻重。传道的人不讲「重生」的道理，通道的人也不追求「重生」的经验。这是何等可叹的事啊！

然而「重生」的道理和经验不会因人的轻看，忽略便减轻它的价值。传道的人可以不讲重生的道理，也可以告诉人说重生不重生无关紧要，通道的人也可以把它当作一个不急需讨论的神学问题；但

Born Again is not something dispensable nor unserious. To see the Kingdom of God we have to be Born Again, to enter the Kingdom of God we have to be Born Again, to come to God we have to be Born Again, to become the son of God we have to be Born Again.

Alas! so many professed Christians neglect this. So many avowed Evangelists neglect this too! They give emphasis to seeking, investigation, baptism and confirmation, regarding them necessary. They think that doing them will please God, and are entering the Kingdom of God. They look down upon what Jesus values and what Jesus asks us to value. Preachers do not preach the truth of Born Again, the learners seek not the experience of Born Again. What a matter of regret!

However, despising and neglect would not lessen the value of the truth and experience of Born Again. Preachers might not talk about the truth of Born Again, or even tell that Born Again is nothing important. Learners might put it aside as a theological issue not

主耶稣的话「你们必须重生」却永不能改变。除非一个人不要神的儿子，不要进神的国，若不然，我就要对他说：「你必须重生。」

为甚么人必须重生呢？我们要明白这个问题，必须先彻底认清人类在神面前的真面目。但这件事却是我们最难明白的，若不是有神的话清楚将这件事指示我们，恐怕我们至死也不认识自己的真面目。没有镜子我们总不能看见自己的脸，没有神的话我们也是照样总不能看见自己在神面前实在的情形。按我们自己的性情，不但看不见自己的真相，而且也不愿意看见。我们愿意奉承自己，谄媚自己，歌自己的功，颂自己的德，同时还愿意别人也这样待我们，「人同此心，心同此理」，因此人类更没有指望能认识自己了。

感谢神，祂不欺骗我们。祂爱我们。祂爱我们远胜于我们爱自己。祂毫不隐讳的把我们的真相向

urgently necessary. But Lord Jesus' Words 'You must be Born Again' will never change. Unless you don't want to be the son of God, to enter the Kingdom of God, I have to tell you that 'You must be Born Again.'

Why must a man Born Again? We need to understand this issue. We must see the necessities of the human situation before God. However to understand it is most difficult. If the Words of God do not explain it to us clearly, I am afraid we do not know our own situation unto death. We cannot see our face without a mirror, we cannot see clearly our actual situation before God without the Words of God. According to our disposition, we cannot and do not want to see the actual state of ourselves. We would like to flatter ourselves, fawn on ourselves, praise and exalt ourselves, we also want others to do the same to us. People feel and think likewise, so it is hopeless for humans to know themselves.

Thanks to God, He does not deceive us. He loves us. He loves us far more than we love ourselves. He does not resent at all to show

我们显明。听祂的话说：

us our actual situation. Hear what He says:

「耶和華從天上垂看世人，要看有明白的沒有，有尋求神的沒有。他們都偏离正路，一同變為污穢；並沒有行善的，連一個也沒有。」(詩 14:2-3)

“The Lord looks down from heaven on the sons of men to see if there are any who understand, any who seek God. All have turned aside, they have together become corrupt.” (Psalms 14:2-3)

「在祢面前，凡活着的人沒有一個是義的。」(詩 143:2)

“No-one living is righteous before You.” (Psalms 143:2)

「時常行善而不犯罪的義人，世上實在沒有。」(傳 7:20)

“There is not a righteous man on earth who does what is right and never sins.” (Ecclesiastes 7:20)

「我們已經證明：猶太人和希利尼人都在罪惡之下。就如經上所記：沒有義人，連一個也沒有。沒有明白的；沒有尋求神的；都是偏离正路，一同變為無用。沒有行善的，連一個也沒有。他們的喉嚨是敞開的墳墓；他們用舌头弄詭詐；嘴唇里有虺蛇的毒氣；滿口是咒罵苦毒。殺人流血，他們的腳飛跑，所經過的路便行殘害暴虐的事。平安的路，他們未曾知道；他們眼中不怕神。」(羅 3:9-18)

“We have already made the charge that Jews and Gentiles alike are all under sin. As it is written: ‘There is no-one righteous, not even one; there is no-one who understands, no-one who seeks God. All have turned away, they have together become worthless; there is no-one who does good, not even one. Their throats are open graves; their tongues practice deceit. The poison of vipers is on their lips. Their mouths are full of cursing and bitterness. Their feet are swift to shed blood; ruin and misery mark their ways, and the way of peace they do not know. There is no fear of God before their

这就是我们的真相，
这就是全体人类的真相。
「都是偏离正路，一同变为无用。并没有行善的，连一个也没有。」「没有一个是义的。」「犹太人和希利尼人都在罪恶之下。」这些话是神说的。这是「耶和華从天上垂看世人」所得的结论。祂从天上垂看世人几千年之久，看世人在外面有种种的不同——老少的不同、男女的不同、贫富的不同、贵贱的不同、好坏的不同、智愚的不同、文野的不同、美丑的不同，但在一件事上他们却毫无分别——「都偏离正路，一同变为污秽。」

「都是偏离正路，一同变为无用。并没有行善的，连一个也没有。」这几句话如果是出于人的口，我就不敢确信。因为世界上没有一个人能知道世界上所有人实在的状况。全世界的人多得不可胜数，我们所认识的能有多少人

eyes.” (Romans 3:9-18)

This is our actual situation, and that of all humans. “All have turned away, they have together become worthless; there is no-one who does good, not even one.” “No-one living is righteous.” “We have already made the charge that Jews and Gentiles alike are all under sin.” It is what God says. It is the conclusion of “God looks down from heaven”. He has looked down from heaven for thousands of years, to see all kinds of external differences, between the old and the young, male and female, rich and poor, high and low, good and bad, wise and foolish, civilized and uncivilized, beautiful and ugly. However they make no difference in one way – “All have turned aside, they have together become corrupt.”

“All have turned away, they have together become worthless. There is no-one who does good, not even one.” If these words come from man, I am not quite sure, since there is no-one in the world can realize the actual situation of everyone in the world. There are numerous people in the world.

呢？普通人所认识的不过只有自己一家的人，自己的亲族、朋友、同人、邻舍，和一些与自己常相接触往来的人。有些人因为职业和环境的关系，认识的人比较普通人所认识的更多一些；但无论如何，我们决不信世上有一个人能认识全世界人类的百分之一，不用说百分之一，就是能认识全世界人类千分之一、万分之一的人，也不会寻出一个来。

在我们所认识的那少数的人里面，我们能彻底认识的又有多少呢？许多人是我们所认识的，但我们不过认识他们的面貌，知道他们的姓名。有些人我们认识比较深，但也不过认识他们生活的一部分——他们在街市中怎样行走，遇见友人怎样谈话，在办公室里怎样办事，在宴会中怎样应酬。这一部分是显露在人面前的，至于他们自己家庭中的生活究竟怎样，他们自己独处的时候所作的是甚么事，我们就都知道了。许多

How many people can we know? Average people know only their own family, their kin, friends, peers, neighbour, and those we often contact and commune. Some may make more friends than average people, due to their occupation and environment. However we might not know one hundredth of the worldly human beings. Needless to say one hundredth, we cannot find one who knows one thousandth or one ten-thousandth of the worldly human beings.

How many do we know thoroughly among those we know? We know many, but only their faces and names. Some we know deeper, but only part of their lives — how they walk in the marketplace, how they converse with friends, how they behave in the office, how they engage in a banquet. These are the visible external part. However we know nothing what they behave in their families and what they do when they are all by themselves. Many are so wicked. They appear to be honest, clean, just and righteous, those see them think that they do have desirable

人是这样诡诈，在别人面前作出很诚实清洁，公义端正的样子来，别人看见他们以为他们真是品行端正的人；其实在别人看不见的时候，他们的生活和他们所作的事真是卑鄙龌龊到极点。我们若只看他们显露在人前的那一部分生活，怎么能认识他们呢？有些人虽然不至坏到这种地步，可是我们也不能单看他们显露在人前的那一部分生活，就断定他们究竟是怎样的人。或者有些人我们认识得更加清楚，我们和他们在一处同住过几日，我们可以看见他们生活的大部分，但他们的心究竟如何，还不是我们所能知道的。「画虎画皮难画骨，知人知面不知心。」我们对于世上的人所认识的既是这样有限，自然不能断定人类实在的状况是怎样了；但神却不是这样，祂是鉴察人心，试验人肺腑的（耶 17:10）。祂知道人一切的言语行为，祂也知道人心中所存一切的意念（诗 139:1-4）。世界上没有一种隐藏的事

conduct. As a matter of fact their lives and what they do is really most crooked and filthy when nobody sees them. How can we know them seeing only their visible parts of lives? Some may be not so bad, we could not only look at the visible parts of lives to be sure what kind of persons they are. Maybe we know some deep enough, we live with them for days, we can see most of their lives. However we still do not know what they think. We can draw the visible parts of a tiger but not its bones, we get to know a man and his face but not his mind. It is so limited to know people in the world, so it is naturally not for us to make sure their actual situations. But God makes a difference. He searches the heart and examines the mind. (Jeremiah 17:10) He knows all the pragmatics; He also knows all the ideas of our minds. There is nothing in the world hidden from His sight. He looks down from heaven on all mankind for thousands of years. He pays attention on every one in the world. He looks for a good man attentively. The result lets Him

是祂所不能看见的。祂从天上垂看世人几千年之久，留意世界上每一个人；祂细心寻找一个行善的人，结果竟使祂大失所望，因为他们「都是偏离正路，一同变为无用。并没有行善的，连一个也没有。」他们的喉咙是敞开的坟墓；他们用舌头弄诡诈；嘴唇里有虺蛇的毒气；满口是咒骂苦毒。杀人流血，他们的脚飞跑，所经过的路便行残害暴虐的事。平安的路，他们未曾知道；他们眼中不怕神。」祂不但告诉我们世人都是罪人，祂也把世人的罪状一一的宣布出来，使世人再没有为自己辩护的余地。真的，我们若能毫不自欺，容让神用祂的光照亮我们，我们一定会看出自己在神面前真是「从脚掌到头顶没有一处是完全的」。神并不欺骗我们。祂说世上的人都是罪人，因为他们实在都是有罪的。因为神是全知的，所以我信祂所说的话；因为神是信实的，所以我对祂的话更毫无怀疑。

down, for they "all have turned away, have together become worthless; there is no-one who does good, not even one." "Their throats are open graves; their tongues practice deceit. The poison of vipers is on their lips. Their mouths are full of cursing and bitterness. Their feet are swift to shed blood; ruin and misery mark their ways, and the way of peace they do not know. There is no fear of God before their eyes." (Romans 3:13-18) God not only tells us that humans are sinners, He also proclaims our sins one by one, so humans do not have leeway to self-dispute. If we do not deceive ourselves and allow God to light us up, before God we will see us "from the sole of your foot to the top of your head there is no soundness." (Isaiah 1:6) God does not deceive us. He says humans are sinners because we are really sinful. I believe what God says since He is omniscient. I do not give any doubt to His Words since He is trustworthy.

世人都有罪，这事我们已经看清楚了，再进一步的问题就是「罪是起源于人的外面呢，还是起源于人的里面呢？」我们若是向人征求这个问题的答案，一定有许多人要回答说：「罪是起源于人的外面。人本来是好的，只因社会不良，所以那本来良好的人便被恶劣的社会变坏了。」请详细想一想这种说法通不通呢？人是好的，社会是坏的，因此坏社会把好人变坏了。世界上能不能有这种不合理，不可能的事呢？社会是甚么？社会不是一所房屋，不是一座城市，也不是一块地土；社会是人群的集合。若每一个人是好的，他们所集合而成的社会怎能会是坏的呢？因为人是坏的，所以他们所集合而成的社会才是坏的。不是社会把人变坏，乃是坏人组成了坏的社会。这是合理的解释，也是百跌不破的事实。

罪恶不是从外面来的，我们已经证明了。那样它是从哪里来的呢？神

We have made it clear that humans are sinful. Then the next question is: Does sin originate from without or within? If we request reply to this question, many must reply like that, "Sin originates from without. Men are good, but the society is bad. The bad society makes the good men bad." Please contemplate if it is reasonable or not. It says that men are good but the society is bad, so the bad society makes the good men bad. Can there be so unreasonable and impossible thing in the world? What is the society? The society is not a house, a city or a piece of land; it is a group of people. If all are good, how can the society they group be bad? Just because men are bad, so the society they group is bad. It is not that the society makes men bad, but the bad men group a bad society. Such perception is reasonable, since it is an impregnable fact.

Sins do not come from without, it is what we have proved. Where do they come from? The

的话清楚回答了这个问题：「从人里面出来的，那才能污秽人；因为从里面，就是从人心里，发出恶念、苟合、偷盗、凶杀、奸淫、贪婪、邪恶、诡诈、淫荡、嫉妒、谤讟、骄傲、狂妄。这一切的恶都是从里面出来，且能污秽人。」（可7:20-23）啊！这真是十分清楚、十分彻底的答案！世界上的罪虽有千百种，但无一不是从人的心中发源。因为人的心充满了自私、诡诈、贪婪、邪淫、嫉妒、恼恨，以及种种的恶念，所以他们的口才吐出各种的恶言，他们的手才作出各样的恶事，因此社会中才充满了争权夺利、损人利己、营私舞弊、贪赃受贿、欺诈偷盗、抢夺拐骗、绑票勒索、拆白渔利、家庭悖逆、兄弟哄抢、结党纷争、排挤倾轧、嫉妒恼恨、流血杀人、奸淫苟合、纵欲乱伦、挑拨争端、布散谣言、假公济私、倚势凌人、卖主卖友、负义忘恩、倚大欺小、恃强凌弱；争地以战，杀人盈野；争城以战，杀人盈

Words of God make it clear, "What comes out of a man is what makes him unclean. For from within, out of men's hearts, come evil thoughts, sexual immorality, theft, murder, adultery, greed, malice, deceit, lewdness, envy, slander, arrogance and folly. All these evils come from inside and make a man unclean." (Mark 7:20-23) Oh, what a clear and thoroughgoing answer! Although there are numerous sins, all originates from one's heart, without exception. The heart is full of selfish, deceit, greed, envy, hate and all kinds of evil, so abusive language comes from their mouths, all kinds of evil are done by them, and the society is full of power and profit scrambling, harming others for one's benefit, corrupt practice, bribery, cheating and stealing, robbery and abducting, kidnapping and blackmail, swindling, family offences, plundering between brothers, caballing, excluding and infighting, envy and jealousy, bloody murder, illicit sexual relations, incest, provocation, rumour, jobbery, bullying, betrayal of master and friends, being ungrateful and treacherous,

城；以及种种述不胜述的
各样罪恶。真的，世界上
再没有别的地方比人心更
污秽，再没有别的东西比
人心更邪恶。「人心比万物
都诡诈，坏到极处，谁能
识透呢？」(耶 17:9) 神所
说的这两句话真是确切不
移的了。

我们再往下讨论一个
问题——人从多大年岁才
有罪？对于这个问题有人
要回答说：「从十几岁。」
也有人要回答说：「从七、
八岁或四、五岁。」圣经怎
样回答这个问题呢？「恶
人一出母胎就与神疏远，
一离母腹便走错路，说谎
话。」(诗 58:3)「我是在罪
孽里生的，在我母亲怀胎
的时候就有了罪。」(诗
51:5) 神的话告诉我们，人
不是长大以后才变坏的，
乃是本来就是坏的。人犯
罪不是学习的，他们本来
就有罪，本来就会犯罪。
从前我不明白这理，我以
为小孩子是清洁无罪的，
及至他们长大以后，常看
他们的父母、家人、邻舍

swashbuckling, killing and battle
for territories and city
fortifications, and a great variety of
numerous sins. Nowhere in the
world is dirtier than our heart,
nothing is more sinful than our
heart. "The heart is deceitful above
all things and beyond cure. Who
can understand it?" (Jeremiah
17:9) These two sentences from
God are unwavering indeed.

Let us go to another issue: At
what age does one commit the first
crime? Some reply like that, "In
one's teenage." Some answer,
"When one is seven, eight, or even
four to five." How does the Bible
answer? "Even from birth the
wicked go astray; from the womb
they are wayward and speak lies."
(Psalms 58:3) "Surely I was sinful at
birth, sinful from the time my
mother conceived me." (Psalms
51:5) The Words of God reveal that
men do not become bad when they
grow up, but are bad originally.
Men sin not from learning, they are
sinful themselves. I did not
understand it before, I thought that
children are innocent, seeing the
sins of their parents, family and
neighbour, they learn them

犯罪，他们才渐渐学会犯罪。后来我留意观察儿童的生活动作，我才明白事实并不是这样。我看见小孩子本来就有犯罪的倾向，还不很会说话的小孩子就知道自私；就知道夺取别的儿童的玩具；就知道动手打人；就知道贪得无厌；就知道向别人索取东西，却不肯把东西给别人。我们多少次看见小孩子向他们的父母索取食物或玩具，是那样的贪得无厌，要了还要，及至他们的父母向他们索要一点，或是叫他们给他们的弟弟妹妹一些的时候，他们总是不肯给，就是给也不过极少的一点，或是拣选不好的、很小的拿出来给他们，自己却把好的、大的存留起来。这种贪心，这种自私，这种忘恩负义的罪恶，并不是从人学来的，乃是他们生来就有的。这也不足为奇，父母既是有罪的，他们所生的儿女又岂能没有罪呢？黄种人所生的孩子总是黄种人，白种人所生的孩子总是白种人；孩子生出来一定像他

gradually. Observing children's lives and deeds later made me realize it is not so. I found that children are apt to sin. Children who still do not speak well express their selfishness. They grab toys from other children, they raise hands to hit others, they are greedy, they know how to ask for, demand but share unwillingly. We see so many times children greedily ask their parents for food and toys more and more. When their parents demand from them instead, or ask them to share with little brothers and sisters, they will not. Even if they give, but only a little bit, or choosing the worst, sharing the least, keeping the best and the biggest. Such a greedy, selfish, ungrateful and treacherous sin is not learned, but inborn. It is not surprising – how can the offspring of sinful parents be born sinless? Yellow race gives birth to yellow race children, white race gives birth to white race children. Children born are after their parents. How can sinful humans give birth to sinless offspring?

的父母，有罪的人所生的孩子又岂能没有罪呢？

我们现在认清楚人类的真面目了么？都是罪人！都是从里面坏到外面的！都是生下来就有罪，而且一生常常犯罪的！人类在神面前完全败坏了！他们败坏到不可收拾的地步！有些人要藉着「普及教育」去挽救这种败坏的状况；有些人要藉着「提倡道德」去挽救这种败坏的状况；又有些人要藉着「改良社会」的工作去挽救这种败坏的状况。但是结果怎样呢？力气用了不少，结果竟使人大失所望。他们很惊奇的说：「这是怎么回事呢？我们想教育的力量能改善人的思想品行，怎么现在竟没有多少功效呢？我们想一般人那样败坏，是因为少有人提倡道德的缘故，如今我们这样努力提倡，怎么人类仍是照常的败坏呢？我们想人犯罪作恶是因为社会不良的缘故，若是能将社会改好，人一定可以不再犯罪作恶了，怎么我们费了九牛二虎的力气，竟不

Do we realize humans' true features? All are sinful from within to without! We were born sinful, and always sin! Humans are completely corrupted before God! Their corruption is hopeless! Some try to correct the corruptive situation with universal education; some with ethics promotion; some with society reformation. What is the result? Paying quite an effort brings only a despairing result. Amazingly they say, "What is the matter? We think that the power of education can improve men's mind and deeds, but why is it that not much effect can be found? We think that average men's being wicked is due to lacking of ethics. And now we have paid effort on it, but why is that they are still wicked? We think that men's being wicked is due to the bad influence of the society, if only the society is improved, men will not be sinful anymore. However we have made our tremendous effort, but why has not the society been made a little better?" It is not surprising – men are bad from within, so doing

能将社会改得比从前好一点呢？」其实这有甚么稀奇呢？人是从里面败坏的，从外面下手修理一下，怎么能希望有功效呢？树根若是干了，修理树叶有甚么用处呢？泉源若是浊了，要帮助河水变清岂不是徒然的么？神不作这愚笨的事，祂所采用的是「正本清源」的办法。祂知道若叫一个从里面到外面完全败坏了的人去学作好，学行善，是一件不可能的事。祂知道一个人的行为败坏，是因为他的生命先败坏了。祂知道人不能作好事是里面的问题，不是外面的问题；是生命的问题，不是行为的问题。因此祂不教训我们藉着人的方法去改良我们这已经败坏的旧生命，祂只是对我们说：「你们必须重生。」祂的意思是说：「你们的旧生命就是一切罪恶的起源；你们的旧生命永远不能修理得好，永远不能行善，永远不能使我满意。我现今给你们一个彻底的治疗方法，我要你们得着一种新生命以后，你们必

something without does not help. When the root is withered, what use is to prune? If the wellspring is turbid, paying effort to cleansing the river must be a waste. God does not do stupid things. The method He uses is a radical reformation. He knows that it is impossible to bid one who is sinful within and without to learn to be good, to have good deeds. He knows that one's being wicked is because of a wicked life. He knows that men's inability to be good is a matter of within, but not without; of life but not deed. So He does not teach us to use human methods to improve our wicked old lives. He only tells us that, "You must be Born Again." He means that your old lives are the source of the sins, your old lives can never be mended, will never please Me. Now I give you a complete cure, I have to get you a new life, then you will love being good, hate being sinful. Having the new life, you will have good deeds, you can be good, you can please Me, you can enter My Kingdom. Therefore I tell you that "You must be Born Again."

定喜爱善良，恨恶罪恶；
有了这个新的生命以后，
你们方能行善，方能作好，
方能得我的喜悦，方能进
入我的国；因此我对你们
说，你们必须重生。」

三、一个人得了重生有甚么表现？

「风随着意思吹，你
听见风的响声，却不晓得
从哪里来，往哪里去；凡
从圣灵生的，也是如此。」
(约 3:8)

风是人人所明白的一个名词；刮风是人人所懂得的一件事情。我们说某日天气炎热，一点风也没有，某日略有一点凉风，某日刮了半夜大风，到了次日早晨风才止息。又说某日所刮的是西北风。但如果我们问说，某日所刮的大风究竟有多大？那日所刮的风是几丈高？几丈长？几丈宽？是方的还是圆的？是红的还是绿的？大约听见的人都要笑着回答说：「风是看不见的东西，你怎么问这个问题呢？」那样我要反过来问

3. How will one behave being Born Again?

“The wind blows wherever it pleases. You hear its sound, but you cannot tell where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”
(John 3:8)

Everyone knows what wind is, wind blowing is commonly known. Sometimes there is not any wind in a sunny day; another day there is a breeze; some day it was windy at night and there is no more wind in the morning; and one day we have north-west wind. If we ask how strong the wind is, how high the wind is, length in yard, width in yard, square or circular, red or green, those hear this will answer smilingly, “Wind is something invisible. Why should you ask such a question?” Then I will ask in return, “Now that wind is invisible. How can we say it is windy

他说：「风既是看不见的东西，你怎么样知道某日刮风，某日没有飓风，某日刮微风，某日刮大风，某日刮东南风，某日刮西北风呢？」我知道听见的人都会回答说：「风是看不见的东西，然而刮风的时候必定有看得见的现象。几时我们看见那些因着刮风所发生的现象，我们便知道那是刮风了。」

是的，风是眼看不见的东西，刮风是眼看不见的事实。但甚么时候发生这事实，同时必有许多眼可看见的现象来为这眼看不见的事实作见证。没有风的日子，地上的尘土都停留在地面上，林间的树枝与树叶也都静止不动，旗杆上所悬的旗子直垂在杆子顶上，海中的水像镜面那般平坦，没有少许的波浪。但一到刮风的时候，一切便全改变了，地上的尘土扬到空中，树枝与树叶一齐摆摇不止，旗杆顶上的旗子在风中不住的飞舞，海中的水起了极大的波浪，停留在密室中的人虽然看不见室外这

someday, but it is windless the other day; someday we have breeze, someday we have strong wind, and someday we have north-west wind?" I know that hearer will say, "Wind is invisible, but we can see the visible features of wind blowing. Whenever we see the features, we know that the wind is blowing."

Yes, wind is invisible, wind blowing is something we cannot see. But whenever this fact happens, many visible features relating to this invisible fact will prove. In the day of no wind, dust on ground stays there, twigs and leaves remain in peace, the flag on the post dips down, water in the sea is like a mirror, without even a little wave. However in a windy day, everything changes. Dust on the ground dances up the air, twigs and leaves shake and twist, the flag on the post dances in the air, waves upsurge in the sea. People staying inside the chamber see no those features, still can hear the howling roar, telling them strong wind is blowing outside.

种种现象，但也能听见呜呜的巨响，报告给他们说，现在外面刮起了大风。

一个人被圣灵所生是一件事实，但它正如刮风一样，是一件眼看不见的事实。我们未曾看见圣灵怎样来到他的身上，怎样在他里面作工，他怎样获得重生；也未曾看见圣灵所生的那个里面的人是甚么形状，这些都是隐秘的事，是眼看不见的。但他一得了重生，立时就显露出一些特别的现象，他的心思、意志、愿望、生活、言语、行为都与以前大不相同，他的人生有了一种空前的改变。这种改变他自己看得出来，认识他的人更看得出来。这种改变，就是他得了重生以后所必有的一种现象。我们看见这种特殊的现象显在一个人身上，便知道在他里面必是已经发生了一件事实——他得了重生。

一个人平日在思想、言语、行为上充满了罪恶，非但不以为苦，反觉十分高兴。他以为损人可以自己得利，弄诡诈可以发财。

A man born of Spirit is a fact, as wind blowing, though invisible. We have not seen how the Holy Spirit came to him, worked in him, got him Born Again. We see not the shape of the inward man born of the Spirit. These are all mysterious and invisible. When he is Born Again, some special visible features are revealed. His mind, will, wishes, life, words, deeds are different, his life has somewhat unprecedented changes. He can detect such changes himself, so can those know him. These changes happen on one Born Again. When we see special features appearing on a person, we know that something factual happened on him. He has been Born Again.

The mind, words, deeds of a man used to be full of sin, he felt no pain, but very happy instead. He felt that gain at others' expense was profitable, being crafty made

可庆幸的是，一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度，他深深地痛恨罪恶，他以犯罪为世上最苦的事。他看弄诡诈损人所得来的利益如同蛇蝎，如同毒药，必须立时弃掉方能安心。以前罪恶好像他的好友、他的情人，但现在他看罪恶好像不共戴天的仇敌，他恨不得立时与罪恶完全断绝了关系，永不再见面！我们看见这种现象必要感觉希奇，其实这并不是甚么希奇的事，这乃是因为这个人得了重生，得了神的生命，所以有这种奇异的改变。

一个人平日总是遮掩自己的罪恶，显扬自己的善行。听见人讲道论到罪恶，责备犯罪的人，立时掩耳疾走，甚至攻击逼迫那讲论罪恶的人。如果有甚么人把他的罪说出来，劝告他，规责他，那更了不得了，他要立时老羞成怒，挺身起来，以为别人是有意羞辱他，反对他，他总不肯承认自己有甚么罪恶。一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度，他极乐

money. Happily he has had a sudden change in a single day. He feels bitterly sorry for sins, regards committing sins the most painful. He thinks gain at others' expense craftily is something vicious, toxic, getting rid at once gets immediate peace. Sins were good friends, lovers, but now he regards them as sworn enemies, anxious to repudiate any connection with sins immediately, meeting no more! We are amazed to see them. They are not so amazing, it is all because he has been Born Again, getting a new life, having those amazing changes.

One used to cover one's sins, showed off one's good deeds. When one heard discussion on one doing crimes and condemnation, one would flee away, or even attack those talking about crimes. If someone tried to pull him out of sin, urge him, remonstrate him, it was more terrible, he would become angry immediately, get up and regard it a shame and an opposition. He would never admit he was sinful. In a single day, he has suddenly changed. He wants to

意听别人将他的罪恶告诉他。他看这样的人是他的好友；他不再遮掩自己的罪，他承认自己是极坏的人。他不再吹捧自己，夸耀自己；他厌恶自己，在尘土和炉灰中懊悔。我们看见这种改变便知道这人是得了重生。

一个人平日总是自私自利，他思索，说话，行事，作工，总是要求自己的好处；凡事为自己谋求富贵、荣华、安逸、宴乐。他的眼中没有看到他人的痛苦、缺乏、伤心、眼泪，他以为那是与他毫无关系的事。叫他去爱人去说明人，那真无异乎与虎谋皮。一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度。他的心似乎充满了爱，他似乎忘记了他自己，事事想要帮助别人，使别人得益处。他甘心为别人的缘故舍弃自己的利益、金钱、安逸、宴乐、名誉、尊荣，有时甚至损伤自己的身家性命也毫无顾惜。他看见别人缺乏就尽力济助他们；看见别人伤心就设法安慰他们；看

listen to people telling of the sins he did. He regards them good friends. He covers his crimes no more. He admits that he is most wicked. He flatters and boasts himself no more; he abhors himself, and repents in dust and ashes. (Jobs 42:6) Whenever we see those changes, we know that he is Born Again.

One used to act selfishly, whatever he thought, spoke, did and worked was to get nothing but gain. He did everything but to seek one's wealth, luxury, comfort and feasting. He did not see on others' pain, insufficiency, heart breaking and tears, those were none of his business. Bidding him to love and help others was not different from a doomed petition. In a single day, he has changed his attitude suddenly. His heart seems to be full of love and forgets himself, he helps others all the time, for their benefit. He wants to forfeit his own interest, money, comfort, feasting, fame and dignity for others. Sometimes he even does not care about losing his possessions and life. When he sees someone coming to poverty, he tries to help;

见别人跌倒就伸手将他们扶起；看见别人没有得着他们应得着的好处，就尽心竭力的帮助他们，要叫他们也能得着。这种改变也是一个人得重生的一种表现。

一个人平日总是醉心于物质方面的事物，他所追求的不外乎金钱、享用、安逸、娱乐、名誉、尊荣。你若对他讲天上的事、灵界的事，他非但掩耳不听，闭眼不看，他简直要说你迷信，骂你愚腐，笑你是世上第一等笨汉。你若约他去看电影，观剧，喝酒，赛马，他不但毫不推却，并且乐而忘返；你若约他去听道，查经，或与一位热心虔敬的圣徒谈道，他一听见就无异于送他到刑场那样可怕。一夕之间，他忽然改变了态度。他将世上一切的名利、宴乐、财产、享受都看作粪土，专心追求灵界的事。他看天上的事比地上的事贵重千百倍。他忽然绝迹于电影院、跑马场、戏院、酒馆，却踊跃参加讲道会、查经班。他素日所喜爱的

being sad, to comfort; falling, to hold up; not getting deserved benefit, to help them whole-heartedly to acquire. Such changes tell that he is Born Again.

One used to be crazy over materialistic things, what he sought was nothing but money, enjoyment, comfort, entertainment, fame and dignity. If you told him something about heaven and spirit, he not only closed his ears and eyes, he simply said that you were blindly worshipping, gave you silly rebuke, made fun of you the first class idiot. If you asked him to see a film, an opera, to drink, to see horse-racing, he not only did not refuse, but also enjoyed himself blissfully. If you invited him to a preaching, Bible study, or discussion on truth with a pious saint, to him hearing that was as if to send him to execution. In a single day, he has changed his attitude all at once. He sees all the fame, feasting, wealth and enjoyment but dirt, absorbs whole-heartedly in spiritual things

现在变成了所憎恶的；从前所憎恶的现在变成了最喜爱的。他似乎换了一个新的心境、新的性情，这种改变也是证明这个人得了重生。

一个人平日不信圣经，厌恶圣经，轻看笑骂那些信圣经，读圣经的人。他一位热心爱主的朋友，有一次特意买了一本圣经送给他，请他抽暇看看。他因为情面的关系，不得不收下。但他把这本圣经拿回家中以后，连翻也没翻过一次，便把它扔在堆煤的屋子里。若不是因为这本圣经是他朋友送给他的，他早已把它丢到火炉去了。一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度。他笃信圣经，更喜爱圣经；他看圣经比世上任何书籍更宝贵。他翻开圣经去读的时候，觉得有无穷的意味，以致他每逢读的时候总不

instead. He sees things in heaven dearer than those on earth a thousand times. Abruptly he stays out of cinemas, horse tracks, theatres and pubs, and is eager to attend preaching, Bible studying classes instead. What he used to do become something he hates; hate, loves most. It seems that he has a new state of mind and disposition, such changes prove that he is Born Again.

He did not usually believe in Bible, but hated. He laughed at and condemned those who believed in and studied the Bible. A friend of him, who loved God eagerly, bought him a Bible deliberately, and asked him to find time to read it. Just to spare the friend's feelings, he took it. Back to home, he did not read it, not even once, but threw it inside the room storing coal. If this Bible was not a gift from a friend, he would have already thrown it into the fire place. In a single day, he has changed his attitude all of a sudden. He sincerely believes in the Bible, and loves it more. He regards it dearer than any book in the world. When he reads it, it

肯释卷。他觉得圣经里的言语真是「比金子可羡慕，且比极多的精金可羡慕，比蜜甘甜，且比蜂房下滴的蜜甘甜。」他回想自己以前对圣经的态度，再想到现今是怎样爱慕圣经，连他自己也觉得莫名其妙。这也是一个人因得重生所发生的改变。

一个人平日喜欢亲近酒肉世俗的朋友，稍有暇时，便大家聚在一处，嬉戏宴乐，说些粗俗下流的言语，唱些市井的歌曲，行不循轨，言不及义。一见虔诚有德行的信徒，好似遇见毒蛇猛兽一般，尽力远避，惟恐因亲近他们而受损害。有时偶然遇见虔诚的信徒，不及走避，勉强敷衍几句，赶快告辞就走。似乎虔诚的信徒身上发出一种特殊的气味，是他的鼻子所不能忍受的。一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度。他毅然决定离弃旧日的昵友，他不再愿意同他们在一处放荡饮宴，也不再去寻找他们；他们来寻找他的时候，他

keeps pulling him back, that he does not want to put it down. To him reading the Bible is "more precious than gold, than much pure gold; they are sweeter than honey, than honey from the honeycomb." (Psalms 19:10) It is so baffling to have changing attitude to the Bible. These are also the changes happening on one who is Born Again.

One usually liked to get close with worldly friends, they gathered when they had time, had fun and feast, said something scurrilous, sang common songs, acted improperly, said something conveying nothing. When he met pious and virtuous believers, in order not to be hurt, he would escape as if seeing vipers and wild beasts. When having not a chance to escape from the meeting, he would say something perfunctorily and waved goodbye. It seemed that the special odour from pious believers was unbearable to his nose. In a single day, he has changed his attitude all at once. He resolutely decides to leave former close friends, not willing to have feasts dissolutely with them

给他们以闭门羹。同时他开始亲近那些从前他所鄙视、所远离的圣徒。他不惜低首下心地去访谒他们，喜欢与他们谈话，喜欢听他们口中所出智慧的言语，他甘心接受他们的责备和劝诫。他巴不得终日与虔诚的圣徒同处，他看这是荣幸无比的事。这种改变也是告诉我们这个人是得了重生。

一个人平日眼中不怕神，远离神，弃绝神，辱骂神，亵渎神，看热心事奉神的人为迷信，为愚腐，为时代的落伍者。他看见信徒祈祷便批评他们痴呆，他断定祈祷乃是对空气说话，以为这真是一种最无意识的举动。他以为世上只有愚昧无知的人才信神。一夕之间，他忽然完全改变了态度。他笃信神，寻求神，敬拜神，热心事奉神。他常常祈祷，而且非常恳切诚挚。他看那些不信神的人不但十分愚昧，而且可怜至极。他巴不得能帮助每一个他所

everywhere, not to find them either. When they find him, he only turns them down. He also starts to get close to those saints he despised and got away from before. He humbly calls them at any cost, happy to converse with them, listens to their wise words, accepts their condemnation and remonstrating willingly. He abides too anxiously and so much honourably with pious saints. These changes tell us he is Born Again.

One usually did not fear of God, but got away from Him, discarded Him, abused Him, debased Him. He regarded those serving God blind worshipping, stubborn, falling behind the epoch. When he saw believers pray, his remark to them was silly, he concluded that prayer was to speak to air, being an action really meaningless. He thought that only the foolish would believe in God. In a single day, he has changed his attitude at a sudden. He believes in God earnestly, he seeks God, worships God, serves God ardently. He often prays attentively and sincerely. He regards those

接触的人都来与他一同信靠神，事奉神。他以亲近神为最快乐的事，他看远离神为最大的损失。这种非常的改变就是由于这个人得了重生才发生的。

我不能一一细说一个人因得重生所发生的改变。一个自己得了重生的人，必能述说这些现象。我们在那些得了重生的人身上也能看见这种种的改变。总括来说，一个人得了重生以后的生活与心境，与他得重生以前的生活和心境必是完全不同的。他似乎变了另一个人，别人也看出他与从前的不同。他对于自身的改变也感到惊奇。认识他的人或者称赞他，说他从甚么人学好了；或者讥笑他，以为他患了神经病。他自己或者明白这是他蒙了神的恩，得了重生，或者一点不晓得这是怎样一回事。无论别人了解不了解，他自己明白不明白，我们看见这种种的现象和改变，

unbelievers not only really foolish, but also extremely poor. He is too anxious to help everyone he meets to trust and serve God with him. Getting close to God is the happiest thing to do, getting away from Him the biggest loss. These unusual changes happen when he is Born Again.

I cannot tell what happened to those Born Again one by one. One being Born Again can tell such things. We can also see these things in those Born Again. In conclusion, the latter life and mind of one being Born Again are completely different from those of the former. He seems to be another one, others can see he is in different. He himself feels amazed at the changes. Those who know him may praise him, saying he learned from someone; or mocking him to be crazy. He himself may realize that to be Born Again is due to the grace of God, or does not know anything about it. Whether he realizes it or not, understands it or not, we are sure he is Born Again when we see the phenomenon and changes.

都可确知他是重生了。

我说到这里也许有些人要误会我的意思。他们说，是的，我们已经作基督徒许多年，但我们从来不确知是否得了重生。今日你说一个人得了重生必定有甚么改变，必定与从前不同。好了，现在我们晓得我们是得了重生，因为我们已经与从前不同。我们从前一点不知道圣经是怎样的一本书，它的内容是甚么，更不用提了。现今我们知道旧约共有三十九卷，新约有二十七卷。我们也能将各卷的名称从创世记背诵到启示录，并且熟习每卷书中的大意，这是何等大的改变呢？我们从前不会祈祷，不会唱赞美诗，更不到礼拜堂中敬拜神，也不肯在教会中捐钱，现在我们会作私祷，也会作公祷。我们知道怎样谢恩，怎样认罪，怎样为自己，为教会，为世界祈求。我们会唱几百首赞美诗，也常到礼拜堂中敬拜神，并且常在教会中捐钱。我们真是与从前不同了。我们从前抽烟，喝酒，

Up to now some may misunderstand me. They say, "We have been Christians for many years, but we are not sure if we are Born Again. Now you say that one Born Again must have some changes, different from before. Well, we now realize that we are Born Again, because we are different. Before we did not know what the Bible was, or even its content; now we know that there are 39 books in the Old Testament, 27 New. We can name them from Genesis to Revelation, and are familiar with the main idea of each book, what a big change! We did not know how to pray, sing praise, and worship God in church either. We would not donate money, and now we have private and public prayers. We know how to give thanks, convict, plead for ourselves, the Church and the world. We can sing hundreds of songs of praise, worship God in church, and donate money. We are totally different. Formerly we smoked, drank, gambled, scolded, but now we get rid of all these bad habits, are not these amazing changes?

赌博，骂人，现在这些不良的嗜好都戒除了，这不也是奇异的改变么？

我要回答这些人说，是的，你们有这些改变诚然是好的。但你们所有的改变只是这些么？还有许多更重要的改变你们有没有呢？爱罪变为恨罪；喜欢人的称赞变为喜欢人劝责；自私自利变为爱人如己；贪恋世界宴乐变为追求天上应许；厌恶圣经变为爱慕圣经；喜爱结交世俗朋友变为喜爱亲近圣徒；不信神，远离神，褻慢神变为信靠神，敬爱神，热心事奉神的人。这些乃是更重要的改变，乃是里面的改变，乃是生命上的改变，惟独这些改变方能证明一个人真正得了重生。明白圣经，唱赞美诗，祈祷，捐款，到礼拜堂去敬拜神，这些事是可以学习的。无论信的人或是不信的人，得了重生的人或是未得重生的人，稍用一些工夫都可以学会，这些都只是属于外面的。所以只会这些事并不足证明一个人是得了重生。惟独有

Let me answer. Yes, it is good you have these changes. But are these the only changes? Do you acquire those more important changes? Changing from loving sin to hating sin, from loving being praised to being reproached, from selfishness to loving others as yourself, from worldly feasts to seeking heavenly promises, from hating to loving the Bible, from making worldly friends to abiding with saints, from having no faith, getting away from and blaspheming God to trusting, loving and serving God earnestly. These changes are more important, inner and of life. Only these changes prove that one is really Born Again. Understanding the Bible, singing songs of praises, praying, donation of money, worshipping in church, all these can be learned. Whoever believes or not, Born Again or not, will learn it with some effort paid. Doing only these cannot prove that one is Born Again. Only those changes of life can prove that one has a new

了那些生命上的改变，方能证明一个人是得了新的生命，是被圣灵所生。

如果一个人作了基督徒许多时候，学会了祈祷、读经、唱诗、讲道，也戒除了几样不良的嗜好，又常聚会，捐款帮助一些教会的工作；但是他的心思、意志、性情、生活、所喜爱的、所憎恶的，都与从前没有分别：从前喜爱犯罪，现在仍是这样；从前不愿意人说他的过失，现在仍是这样；从前一味的自私自利、损人利己，现在仍是这样；从前对人没有丝毫的爱心，现在仍是这样；从前专一追求，贪恋属物质的好处，厌恶天上的事，现在仍是这样；从前不爱圣经，不愿意读圣经，现在仍是这样；从前远离虔诚的人，亲近世俗的朋友，现在仍是这样；从前远离神，轻慢神，现在仍是这样。这样的一个人，就是他能将全本圣经从第一章到末章都背诵得烂熟，能将他的家产捐上一半，能在讲台上口若悬河，滔滔不断，长篇大论

life, is Born of the Spirit.

One became a Christian long ago knows how to pray, read the Bible, sing songs of praises, preach and give up some bad habits. He has gatherings, donates money in Christian affairs, but his mind, will, disposition, life, things he likes or hates are not different from before. He committed crimes before, and now does the same. He did not like condemnation, and is now the same. He used to be selfish, benefit himself at the expense of others, and is now the same. He did not have mercy on others, and is now the same. He used to seek and love materialistic interest exclusively, hate heavenly affairs, and is now the same. He did not use to love and read the Bible, and is now the same. He used to get away from the pious but get close to worldly friends, and is now the same. He used to stay away from and dishonour God, and is now the same. One who can even cite from the first chapter to the last chapter of the Bible, donate half of his possessions, and preach

地讲道，就是他作过几十年的基督徒，作过执事、长老、牧师、会长、监督、主教，他自己告诉我说他已经得了重生，别人也为他作见证说他是重生的人，我仍不能信他们所说的事实，因为他没有新生命的表现。

自然我不是说一个人一旦得了重生，立时就成为一个人，也不再有任何的过失、缺欠、软弱、失败。一个人得了重生以后，需要日日长进，渐渐达到完全的地步。一个重生的人或者有许多缺欠过失，也可能陷在大罪里，但无论如何，他一定有过生命上的改变，这种改变就是他得了重生的确据。

一个春天的早晨，我同一位朋友坐在一座小山上向四面眺望，看见湖面的水平静得像镜子一般，树叶和青草都一点不动，远方一座楼顶旗杆上所挂的旗子直垂在杆上，完全看不出是甚么旗子，大道上没有丝毫的尘土扬起。除去几只吱吱乱叫的小鸟

eloquently, fluently and long-windedly in the pulpit. Or he has been for decades a Christian, a deacon, an elder, a priest, a president, an overseer, a bishop, he himself tells me that he is Born Again, others give witness that he is Born Again, but I still cannot believe what they say, due to lacking of symptoms of life.

I do not mean that one Born Again will naturally become a perfect man, without a shred of faults, deficiency, weakness and fail. One being Born Again needs to grow up gradually unto perfect. One being Born Again may have many deficiencies and faults, or even commit serious crime, nevertheless, he has come across changes in life, it proves that he is Born Again.

One morning in spring, I sat on a hill to look around with a friend, the lake had smooth water like a mirror, leaves and grasses did not sway, the flag on the top of a building far away dipped down on the pole, it could not be seen what flag it was. On the road no dust was raised. In spite of the birds' chit-chat, all was in peace, without

以外，全地都是十分的寂静，听不见一点声音。忽然我的朋友开口对我说道：「哎呀！风刮得怎么这样大啊！」我听见这话不禁十二分的惊奇，我想我的朋友若不是在那里说梦话，便是他的神经有甚么毛病。风固然是人的眼睛所看不见的东西，刮风也是人的眼睛所看不见的事，然而刮风的时候一定有因刮风所引发的现象，方能使我们确知那时正在刮风。一个人从圣灵得着重生也是这样。看不见一点刮风的现象，我决不能信刮过了风；照样，看不见一点重生的表现，谁能信一个人是得了重生呢？

四、怎样方能得重生？

「摩西在旷野怎样举蛇，人子也必照样被举起来，叫一切信祂的都得永生。」(约 3:14-15)

在这一段话中主耶稣指示尼哥底母得重生的方法。祂引用了一件古时以色列人所经历的事实，来阐明重生的要道。我们要

any sound. Suddenly my friend said to me, "Oh, what a big wind!" Hearing this, I was amazed indeed. I thought he had to be dreaming, or he was crazy. Surely wind is not invisible, wind blowing could not been seen, however we can surely know the wind blows with the phenomenon seen. It is the same with one Born Again. We cannot say it is windy without the phenomenon, similarly without the indication of Born Again, who can say that one is Born Again?

4. How can one be Born Again?

"Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the desert, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life." (John 3:14-15)

In Jesus' Words He suggested the way to be Born Again to Nicodemus. He quoted a historical event of the ancient Israelites to explain it. We have to understand it

清楚知道这一件事实，所以容我们先读这一段旧约的记载：

「他们从何珥山起行，往红海那条路走，要绕过以东地。百姓因这路难行，心中甚是烦躁，就怨讟神和摩西说：『你们为甚么把我们从埃及领出来，使我们死在旷野呢？这里没有粮，没有水，我们的心厌恶这淡薄的食物。』于是耶和华使火蛇进入百姓中间，蛇就咬他们。以色列人中死了许多。百姓到摩西那里，说：『我们怨讟耶和华和你，有罪了。求你祷告耶和华，叫这些蛇离开我们。』于是摩西为百姓祷告。耶和华对摩西说：『你制造一条火蛇，挂在杆子上，凡被咬的，一望这蛇，就必得活。』摩西便制造一条铜蛇，挂在杆子上，凡被蛇咬的，一望这铜蛇就活了。」(民 21:4-9)

我们要注意这一段事迹的起源。以色列人被火

clearly. Let us read the Old Testament record:

“They travelled from Mount Hor along the route to the Red Sea, to go round Edom. But the people grew impatient on the way; they spoke against God and against Moses, and said, ‘Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the desert? There is no bread! There is no water! And we detest this miserable food!’ Then the Lord sent venomous snakes among them; they bit the people and many Israelites died. The people came to Moses and said, ‘We sinned when we spoke against the Lord and against you. Pray that the Lord will take the snakes away from us.’ So Moses prayed for the people. The Lord said to Moses, ‘Make a snake and put it up on a pole; anyone who is bitten can look at it and live.’ So Moses made a bronze snake and put it up on a pole. Then when anyone was bitten by a snake and looked at the bronze snake, he lived.” (Numbers 21:4-9)

We have to pay attention to the cause of the story. The

蛇所咬，乃是因为他们埋怨神。他们所以埋怨神，乃是因为他们走过一段难走的路。神使他们走过这一段路不是害他们，也不是苦待他们，正是为他们的益处，要把他们领进那流奶与蜜的迦南地，叫他们承受那地为业。请看神待他们的恩典是何等浩大。祂先从埃及为奴的地方和凶残的法老手下把他们拯救出来，又应许领他们到那迦南乐土。他们得着这样大的恩典，应当怎样感谢神，怎样顺服神才合乎理？就是在路上遇见一点难处，也应当忍耐片时，盼望快些走到迦南地，这些困难自然都没有了。谁想到神待他们这样好，他们竟发出怨言来，说神把他们从埃及领出来，要使他们死在旷野。领受这样大的恩典，不知感谢已经是忘恩，如今还更进一步向神发出这种负义的怨言来，这些以色列人的罪大到了甚么地步？请问神预备火蛇咬死他们是不是他们应得的分呢？然而神还怜恤他们，垂顾他们的

Israelites were bitten by venomous snakes because they spoke against the Lord after treading a hard route. God led them on the route not to ruin or harm them, but for their benefit instead, to bring them to inherit Canaan, the land flowing with milk and honey. What a blessing from God! He saved them from Egypt, the land of slavery and the fierce hands of Pharaoh, and promised to bring them to Canaan the good land. Having grace so amazed, what measure of thanksgiving and serving to God was suitable? The hardship on the way should be endured a bit more. Hopefully arriving at Canaan soon, the hard feeling would dissolve apparently. God treated them well, but against Him they spoke, 'Why have You brought us up out of Egypt to die in the desert?' Receiving grace so great and giving no thanks was ungrateful, saying further against God was treacherous. What extent of sin do these Israelites have? Was God sending them deadly venomous snakes not appropriate? However God had looked on them, showed concern for them. He bid Moses to

苦情，吩咐摩西为他们预备一种救法，命他们看铜蛇得着医治。

请注意：每一个被火蛇所咬的人的生命已经断绝了。虽然被蛇咬以后的几小时或是一两天以内他还活着，照常动作，像常人一样，但蛇的毒已经进入他的血脉，他已经列入死人之数。再说得清楚一点，他已经是死人了。但他听了摩西的话去望铜蛇以后又活了。我们当确实的知道，他望铜蛇以后的生命并不是以前的那个生命，乃是重新得了一个生命。换一句话说，那个被火蛇所咬的人，在望铜蛇的时候无异乎又被生了一次，成为一个新人。他望铜蛇以后的身体仍是以前的身体，面貌也仍是以前的面貌，但生命却不是以前的生命了。他以前的旧生命在他被火蛇所咬的时候已经完结了，他现在所有的新生命乃是在他看铜蛇的时候重新得着的。

主耶稣就是用这件事来教导尼哥底母，将一个

prepare a rescue, instructed them to look at the bronze snake to live.

Pay attention here. One bitten by venomous snakes was dead in lives. Hours or days after the biting he might still live and act like ordinary people, but the snake venom had entered the blood, so he fell under the list of the dead. To make it clearer, he was already dead. When he heard Moses and looked at the bronze snake, he lived. We should make it sure, after looking at the bronze snake, his life was no more the former one, he got a life once again. In other words, when he, bitten by venomous snake, saw the bronze snake, it made no difference of being Born Again, he became a new man. After looking at the bronze snake, the body was still the former body, the face was the former face, but the life was not the former one. The old life ended when bitten by the venomous snake, the new life now was acquired after looking at the bronze snake.

Lord Jesus used this to teach Nicodemus, to show him the way

人得重生的方法指示他。祂告诉尼哥底母说：「摩西在旷野怎样举蛇，人子也必照样被举起来，叫一切信祂的都得永生。」祂告诉尼哥底母说，世上的人类同古时的以色列人是一样的犯了罪，一样的触动了神的震怒，一样的丧失了生命。虽然世人现在还照常活着，实际上他们已经列入死人之数。但神却向他们大发怜悯，正如祂在古时向以色列人大发怜悯一般。祂为他们预备了一个救法，不是一条铜蛇挂在杆子上，乃是一位圣洁无瑕的羔羊挂在木头上。祂吩咐那些丧失了生命的以色列人去看铜蛇好得生命，祂也吩咐现在世上一切丧失了生命的世人来信耶稣好得生命。丧失了生命的以色列人在望铜蛇的时候怎样重新得了生命，丧失了生命的世人也照样在信耶稣的时候重新得着生命。因此我们的问题「怎样方能得重生？」在这里便得了一个清楚的答案——信耶稣基督。

必有人说：「得重生

to be Born Again. He told Nicodemus, "Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the desert, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life." He told Nicodemus that people in the world, just like the ancient Israelites, sin, stir up God's wrath and lose their lives. Although they live as usual, they have been actually taken into account of the dead. But God has mercy on them, as if to the ancient Israelites. He prepares for them redemption, not a bronze on a pole, but a sacred spotless lamb on the tree. He commanded those Israelites who lost their lives to look at the bronze snake to live, He commands people in the world who lose their lives to believe in Jesus to live. Looking at the bronze snake, the Israelites who lost their lives got new lives. Likewise, believing in Jesus, all the people in the world who lose their lives get new lives again. So the clear answer here for our question 'How can one be Born Again?' is to 'Believe in Jesus Christ.'

Some must say, "The way to

的方法既是这样简单，那么所有基督徒必是都已经得重生了。但照前一章所提的一个人得重生以后所有的改变看来，却证明在基督徒当中有许多人是未得重生的，因为在他们的生活中从来未曾有过那些改变。这到底是怎么一回事呢？」

我们要明白这事，须先清楚明白「信耶稣」究竟是怎么一回事。我们以为一切称为基督徒的都已经信了耶稣么？不，在那些人里，实在有一部分已经信了耶稣，但其中还有许多人离信耶稣有几千万里呢。容我们回到以色列人看铜蛇这件事来看。

一个被火蛇所咬的以色列人来望铜蛇是十分容易的事，然而这件十分容易的事却包含了几个重要的步骤：

第一，那个被蛇所咬的人必须知道他是被蛇咬了，然后他方肯来望铜蛇。假使有一个以色列人在睡觉的时候被蛇咬了，他睡醒以后并不知道有一条火

be Born Again is so simple, then all Christians must have been Born Again. But according to the changes of the Born Again mentioned in the last chapter, it proves that among the professed Christians, there are many not yet Born Again, because no such changes have been seen. What is it all about?"

To understand it, we need to make sure what 'Believing in Jesus' means. We think that all those professed Christians have believed in Jesus. No, some of them indeed have believed in Jesus, but many of them are at a distance of believing in Jesus, thousands of miles away. Let us go back to the case of looking at the bronze by the Israelites.

To an Israelite, bitten by a venomous snake, looking at the bronze snake was an easy job. However it consisted of a few important steps:

First, the one bitten by a venomous snake would look at the bronze snake only if he knew that he was bitten. Suppose one was bitten during sleeping. When he woke up, he did not know that he

蛇曾咬了他，并且也没有别人看见这事来告诉他，请问他要不要去看铜蛇呢？自然不要去的。第二，那个被蛇所咬的人必须知道他被蛇咬的结果是何等可怕。因为被蛇所咬不是疼痛几日，也不是红肿多少时候，或是受一些别的苦楚就完了。被蛇所咬的人是必定要死的。假使有一个以色列人被蛇咬了，但他想这并无要紧，请问他要不要急忙去看铜蛇呢？自然他也不要去的。第三，那个被蛇所咬的人必须知道他自己没有一点方法能救自己。假使他想他手中有一种善治毒虫咬伤的良药，或是他想他精通医术，可以治疗自己的创伤，或是他想起他朋友曾介绍一种消毒的良药给他，即刻可以取出药来使用，这样他也不要去看铜蛇了。第四，那个被蛇所咬的人必须深信神的话。他信神藉摩西所传达的消息，信他照神所指示的去望铜蛇就必得医治，必得存活。这样他方会去看铜蛇。假使他不信神的话，

had been bitten by a venomous snake, and not any one saw and told him all about it. Would he go to look at the bronze snake? Naturally not. Second, the one bitten had to understand the horrible result of the biting. Being bitten not only made one feel painful for some days, or swell for a period of time, or have some other suffering, the one bitten would die. But if he thought that it was nothing important, would he hurry to look at the bronze snake? Naturally not. Third, the one bitten had to realize that there was no way to save by himself. Suppose he thought that he had some special cure for venomous insects bite; or he himself, was skilful in curing, thought that he could heal his wound; or he recalled that a friend had suggested a good fumigating cure which he could use, then he did not want to look at the bronze snake. Fourth, the one bitten had to trust the Words of God profoundly. He believed in what God told Moses, believing that looking at the bronze snake as suggested to be healed and to live. That is why he went and looked. If

我想他也必不去望铜蛇了。

一个因罪而丢失生命的罪人来信耶稣也是一件很容易的事，但这件容易的事也包含了相同的四个步骤：第一，一个罪人必须知道自己真是犯了罪；第二，他必须知道犯罪的必要死亡；第三，他必须知道他毫无方法可以救自己；第四，他必须信神的话，仰望那挂在木头上的耶稣基督。一个被毒蛇咬了的以色列人有了以上四步经验怎样立刻得了医治，照样一个罪人有了以上四步经验也就立刻得了拯救，得了重生。

现今各地称为基督徒的数目诚然不少，但实在有过以上所提的四步经验的人究竟有多少呢？许多称为基督徒的不用说信神的话，仰望耶稣，甚至他们从来就未曾有一次真实彻底的知道自己有罪，更从来未曾想到罪人的结局是如何的可怕，如何的危险。不是有许多人加入教会是因为生计困难，找事

one did not have faith on the Words of God, I think he would not go and look at the bronze snake.

One, who lost his life, coming to believe in Jesus is also an easy job, which consists of the same four steps: First, a sinner has to know that he sins indeed. Second, he has to know that a sinful man must die. Third, he has to know that he cannot be saved by any other method. Fourth, he has to believe in the Words of God, looking at Jesus Christ hanging on the tree. An Israelite bitten came over these four steps to be healed, likewise, a sinner coming over the four steps will be saved all at once, and be Born Again.

Nowadays there are indeed numerous professed Christians around the world, but how many of them have come across the four steps? Many professed Christians have never believed in the Words of God, looked at Jesus, nor really thoroughly realized they are sinful, not even once. They have never thought of the extreme horrible and dangerous destiny of sinners. We know that many joined the

不易，想在教会或教会附属的机关里谋一个吃饭的地方，所以作了基督徒么？不是有许多人因为在教会学校里教授，在教会的医院里服务，或是教外籍宣教士学习华语，或是在牧师、教士的宅院里当佣工，为要巩固自己的差事起见，所以作了基督徒么？不是有许多人无力供自己的孩子入学，但看见信徒的孩子可以在教会的学校里免费读书，为了分沾这一种利益起见，所以作了基督徒么？不是有许多人因为看见在礼拜堂中有风头可出，有尊荣可得，所以作了基督徒么？不是有许多人想要娶女信徒为妻，或是想要嫁给男信徒，但对方因他们不是基督徒不肯允许，他们为要达到目的所以作了基督徒么？不是有许多人并不清楚认识耶稣是谁，也不明白为甚么要信基督，更不知道信耶稣可以得着甚么好处，只是盲目的随从别人的劝诲，糊糊涂涂地就作了基督徒么？比这些较好一点的，有些人是因为想

Church because of difficult livelihood. They became Christians just to get jobs in the Church or corresponding organizations. Some teach in schools run by the Church, serve in hospitals run by the Church. Some might teach missionary Chinese, or work as servants in the houses of priests or missionaries, becoming a Christian gave help to one's occupation. Some could not afford to send children to school, knowing that children of believers could study in school run by the Church free of charge, so they became Christians to have a share of the benefit. Some became Christians because seeing that there were opportunities to be in the limelight, to have fame. Many wanted to have a believer wife or husband, their becoming Christians was the way to get the agreement. Many did not know who Jesus was, nor knew why to believe in Christ, not even knew the benefit of believing in Jesus. They only followed advice blindly, and became Christians foolishly. Some were better, they believed because they thought that Jesus' teaching would build them

耶稣的教训可以造成伟大的人格，所以作了基督徒。有些人以为人必须信宗教，但各宗教中最好的首推基督教，所以作了基督徒。有些人想耶稣的道理可以帮助人齐家治国，改造社会，所以作了基督徒。有些人想耶稣的道理可以给人精神上的安慰，所以作了基督徒。以上所说的这些作基督徒的动机虽然各不相同，但在几样最要紧的事上却毫无差别，就是：他们都未曾知道自己有罪；都未曾知道罪人的结局；都未曾知道自己不能救自己；都未曾信神的话，来仰望那被挂在木头上，为人赎罪的主耶稣。这些人自己说他们是基督徒，其它人也有承认他们是基督徒，称呼他们为基督徒的。这些人中甚至有一些还自称是为神作工的，是传道士，是牧师，是长老，是执事。别人也这样称呼他们。但用圣经中所讲的「信」作标准来衡量这些人，便知道他们实在未曾真信耶稣。他们既然未曾真信耶稣，自然 great character. Some thought that we must have a religion, and Christianity is the best choice, so they became Christians. Some think that Jesus' Words could help to bring us good families, reformed society and a good country, so they believed for these reasons. Some became Christians because they thought that Jesus' principle is a good comfort to men's mentality. All these are various motives to be Christians, but in several essential things they show no difference: they have not known their sinfulness, the destiny of sinners, their inability to save themselves, believing not in the Words of God to look at Saviour Lord Jesus on the tree. These are professed Christians, with confirmation from the others, calling them Christians. Some of them claim that they work for God, being a preacher, priest, elder or deacon, it is also how people salute them. If measured by faith, the standard set in the Bible, they have not yet believed in Jesus. Not yet believing in Jesus, naturally and beyond doubt they have not been Born Again. We must not regard those joining in a church

未曾得着重生，这是毫无可疑的事了。我们切不要以为每一个加入教会自称为基督徒的人便是真信耶稣的人，便是真得了重生的人。惟独那些真有过上面所提的四步经验的人才是真信了耶稣，真得了重生的人。许多称为基督徒的人根本就未曾信耶稣，未曾得重生，这些人从未有过前一章所提的那些改变，本是理所当然的事，又有甚么希奇呢？

称为基督徒的人中有许多已经得了重生，这是毫无可疑的事实，但不是所有称为基督徒的都是得了重生的人。一个人得重生并不在乎他在哪个教会记名，在哪个教会受洗，到哪个礼拜堂去聚会，也不在乎他帮助过多少传道的事工，在教会里捐过多少金钱，或是他在教会里任过甚么职分。一个人得重生唯一的方法就是知道自己有罪，知道自己的危险，知道自己无法拯救自己，听见神的福音就信从，就来仰望被钉十字架的耶稣，未曾得重生的人走这

Christians, nor believing in Jesus, nor being Born Again. Only those coming across the four steps mentioned are real believers and Born Again. Many professed Christians have not believed in Jesus basically, naturally and not amazingly they have not been Born Again. They have not come across the changes.

Among the professed Christians, many have been Born Again, it is an undoubted fact, but not all professed Christians are Born Again. One being Born Again is not of name recorded, baptism, and services attending in a church. It is not of the assistance in preaching work, money donation or the rank and file in a church. The only way to be Born Again is to know one's dangerous sinful situation, to know the inability to save oneself, to listen to and believe in God's Gospel, and to look at the crucified Jesus. Those not yet Born Again treading on this road will get it. Those treading on

条道路立刻就能得重生。走过这条路的人就已经得了重生。

在这里我们又看出得重生是很快的一件事。那个被蛇所咬的以色列人「一望铜蛇就活了」。注意这个「一望铜蛇就活了」。那个望铜蛇的人在很短的时间内就因信得了生命。他来的时候还是必死的人，他回去的时候已经成为活人了；五分钟以前还是绝望的人，五分钟以后便出死入生了。一个罪人因信耶稣基督而得重生也是这样。只要这个人真认识了自己，真知道了自己的污秽、不义、痛苦、绝望，愿意笃信神的话，信靠那为罪人舍命的基督，甚么时候他这样作，神就在那时藉着祂的灵和祂的道重生了这人，使他得着新生命，使他成为神的儿子。昨天他还是死人，今日他已经得了生命；昨天他还遍体污秽，今日他已经像雪一样的洁白；昨天他还是神的仇敌，今日他已经成为神的儿子。第一次生产是很快的事，一个

have been Born Again.

Here we see that being Born Again is instantaneous. The Israelite, being bitten by venomous snake, lived after looking at the bronze snake. Pay attention to 'look at it and live'. Looking at the bronze snake believingly, one lived in an instant. When coming, he surely was dead, returning he lived. Five minutes ago he had been desperate, five minutes later he passed from death unto life. Similarly a sinner believes in Jesus Christ to be Born Again. So long as one knows oneself, realizes one's filthiness, injustice, agony, despair indeed and adheres to the Words of God, trusts Christ who laid down His life for sinners. Whenever one does these, one will be Born Again by God's Spirit and His Words, and has new life, becomes the son of God. Yesterday he was dead, today he lives. Yesterday he was completely filthy, today he is as white as snow. Yesterday he was an enemy of God, today a son of God. The first giving birth is fast. Someone went to a delivery room,

小孩未出生前，有人到产房里来，还看不见小孩子的形迹，过了十几分钟再进来，便看见了呱呱坠地的鲜活婴儿卧在那里。第二次生产（重生）也是这样的迅速，所不同的就是第一次的生产是一件眼能看见的事实，第二次生产是一件眼不能看见的事实罢了。

按圣经所讲的道理来说，一个人的罪无论怎样大，他的境况无论怎样可怜，只要他真知道自己有罪，真有诚恳悔改求救的心，笃信神的话来投靠耶稣基督，他立时便得赦罪，便被称义，便得重生，便有永生，便成为神的儿子。不知道甚么缘故，这宝贵的福音竟被人讲得乱七八糟，以致多少人以为得救是极困难的事，重生是最不易得的经验，永生总须等到死后才能得着。因此许多已经真实悔改的信徒仍是常存着畏惧战栗的心追求要得救，迫切呼求神重生他们，盼望死后或者能有永生，每逢祷告的时候总是满口「罪人不配祷

no baby was seen; ten minutes later a newborn fresh living baby was lying in bed. The second giving birth (Born Again) is as swift as the first one, what is different is the first one visible, while the second one invisible.

According to the Biblical truth, no matter how serious one's sin is, how pitiful one's situation is, what one has to do is to know one's sinfulness, with a heart of sincere repent to be saved, believe in the Words of God and surrender to Jesus Christ, then one will be saved, justified, Born Again and has new life at once. We do not know why such precious Gospel is being misinterpreted, that so many think that being saved is difficult, Born Again cannot be experienced easily, eternal life could only be acquired after death. That is why so many truly converted believers often cry unto Lord to be saved with a trembling heart, they ask to be Born Again desperately, hoping that they have eternal life after

告，不敢祷告」这一类的话。许多被罪压伤痛苦绝望的罪人满心想得救，但他们听说得救是这样不易，求永生是这样艰难，他们因此裹足不前，徘徊歧途。要挽救这种可怕的现象，最要紧的就是使人明白真诚悔改信靠耶稣，立时就得重生，就有永生，就蒙拯救。讲明这种根本的要道，真是今日急不容缓的事啊！

是的，主耶稣在十字架上已经完成了救工，不用我们再设甚么方法去救自己，也不用我们再在这种救工上加添甚么。只要真诚悔改，承认自己的罪，全心信靠那为我们舍命的主耶稣，立时就得拯救，立时就得重生，立时就有永生。你还未这样信么？现在就信，现在你就能得着重生，得着永生。你已经这样信了么？你当知道你已得了重生，有了永生了，因为主耶稣绝不欺骗我们。祂的话是可信的。祂说：「摩西在旷野怎样举蛇，人子也必照样被举

death. Whenever they pray, 'unworthy sinners dare not pray' is often heard. Many painful and desperate sinners, bruised by iniquities, long to be saved, they are told that being saved is not easy. Acquiring eternal life is so difficult that they hesitate and wander about. As a remedy of this terrible situation, to be Born Again, to have new life and to be saved, it is essential for one to truly repent and believe in Jesus. Clearly stating such radical truth is most urgent.

Yes, Lord Jesus has accomplished salvation on the cross, we do not need any method to save ourselves, or add anything on this saving work. Just truly repent, confess our sinfulness, wholeheartedly believe in Lord Jesus who died for us, then one is saved, Born Again and has eternal life at once. Haven't you believed it yet? Believe now, and you can be Born Again and have eternal life. Have you believed that way? You should know that you are Born Again and having eternal life, since Lord Jesus must not deceive us. His Word is trustworthy. He says, "Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the

起来，叫一切信祂的都有永生。」

desert, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.” (John 3:14-15)

五、得了重生的人还能犯罪么？

我们现在所要讨论的问题并不是「得了重生的人还可以犯罪么？」圣经对于这个问题已经给了一个很清楚的答案说：「断乎不可！」(参罗 6:1-2) 我们的问题也不是「得了重生的人还愿意犯罪么？」没有一个得了重生的人还愿意犯罪，一个人若愿意犯罪就足证明他未得重生。我们的问题，更不是「得了重生的人还应当犯罪么？」这个问题简直不成问题，世界上没有一个人应当犯罪。我们的问题乃是「得了重生的人还能犯罪么？」换一句话说就是「得了重生的人还有没有犯罪的可能性？」

许多虔诚的信徒因为不十分明白这一件事，以致自取了多少无谓的惧怕、忧愁、失望和痛苦。这些人是真实信主得了重

5. Will one Born Again sin?

What we are now going to discuss is not “*Can* one Born Again sin?” The Bible has a definite answer, “By no means!” (Cf Roman 6:1-2) Our question is not “Does one Born Again *will* to sin?” either. No one Born Again wants to sin. One’s willingness to sin proves one not yet Born Again. Our question is not “*Should* one Born Again sin?” even. This question is not a question at all. No-one in the world should sin. Our question is “*Would* one Born Again sin?” In other words, “Is it *possible* for one Born Again to sin?”

Many pious believers do not understand it, so they incur so much unnecessary fear, worry, despair and agony. They are true converts and Born Again. When

生的人，他们在悔改信主的时候是那样的为自己的罪忧伤懊悔，那时他们恨罪到了极点，他们定意一生与罪断绝关系。他们决志再不犯罪，他们想他们既然这样恨恶罪恶，决志离弃罪恶，一定可以毕生不再犯罪了。不料过了一些日子，他们竟然犯罪，甚至老犯的，还是在人眼中看为很重大的罪。他们在那时就怀疑到了自己是否重生的问题，不然，怎么会又犯罪了呢？如果他们听过甚么人讲道说「得了重生的人一定不能再犯罪」，他们更会信自己是未曾得重生了。他们既然以为自己未得重生（其实他们已经得了重生），自然要再去追求重生的经验。他们再去悔改，再去信主，再恳切的在神面前为罪自卑。他们想现在他们得重生了，今后可以不再犯罪了。不料过了一些日子他们又犯了罪。到这时他们真觉得莫名其妙。他们想自己到底有没有得了重生呢？若说没有，自己真有过重生的经验；若说有，

they repented, they felt sorry for their sins, hating sins to one's heart, and decided to break off with sin whole life long. They determined not to sin, they thought that their definite hatred of sin and willingness to abandon sin will lead them a life of no sins. However, they sinned soon, the usual ones, and the serious ones in others' eyes. They doubted if they were Born Again, otherwise, how would one Born Again sin again? If they heard preaching like that "Those Born Again must not sin", they were convinced that they had not been Born Again. Now that they regarded themselves not yet Born Again, naturally they would once again ask for the experience of Born Again. They repented again, believed in Lord again, pleaded humbly and sincerely before God for their sins. They thought that they were Born Again, they would not sin any more. But very soon they sinned again. They were puzzled then. They did not know if they were Born Again. If not, how comes their experience of Born Again? If yes, how comes they still sinned then? Coming to such

怎么到如今还能犯罪呢？一个信徒走到这种地步是最容易失望跌倒的，或者他竟会完全疑惑他所信的道理来也未可知。

还有些信徒弄出一种比这个更危险的错误来。他们在得了重生以后偶然又犯了罪，便以为他们从此灭亡了。他们以为现在犯的罪再不能盼望得赦免。他们想现在犯罪乃是明知故犯，现在所作的乃是亵渎圣灵（其实亵渎圣灵是甚么意思他们还不晓得）。他们以为已得重生的人如果再犯罪便不能再得赦免。这种错误的观念不知道害了多少信主的人。他们并未被神弃绝，但他们以为他们已经被弃绝，所以他们一生度着畏惧、绝望、痛苦、悲观的生活。他们自己的境况既然这样困苦可怜，自然更不能帮助别人，引领别人了。

圣经怎样回答这个问题呢？

「我们若说自己无罪，便是自欺，真理不在我们心里了。我们若认自己的罪，神是信实的，是

situation, a believer is apt to be desperate and fail, or even doubt the truth believed.

Some other believers made a more serious mistake. After Born Again they sinned occasionally and thought that they would perish henceforth. They thought that they were hopeless to be pardoned because of the new sins. They regarded the new sins deliberate, blaspheming against the Holy Spirit (which they did not understand). They thought that those Born Again could not be pardoned for they sinned again. This wrong concept ruins so many believers. Thinking of being banished by God makes them lead a life of fear, despair, agony and gloom. Their situation is so broken and poor, that they could not help and lead others naturally.

How does the Bible answer such question?

“If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves and the truth is not in us. If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just and will

公义的，必要赦免我们的罪，洗净我们一切的不义。」(约壹 1:8-9)

这段经文中的「我们」是甚么人呢？约翰这封信不是写给未得重生的人，乃是写给已经得了重生的人的。而且他不是说「你们」，乃是说「我们」，那是连他自己也包括在里面了。大概总不会有人说写那封信的老使徒约翰未曾得重生吧。他说：「我们若说自己无罪，便是自欺，真理不在我们心里了。」如果得了重生的人不能再犯罪，这两句话又怎样讲呢？往下他又告诉我们一个得洁净的方法：「我们若认自己的罪，神是信实的，是公义的，必要赦免我们的罪，洗净我们一切的不义。」这里约翰说我们知道我们有罪，但不必绝望，不必畏惧，只要我们能认自己的罪，就必得着赦免和洗净。同时我们在这一节经文中又可以看出得了重生的人仍能犯罪，正因为得了重生的人能犯罪，所以他们须要认罪，好得着赦免和洗净。容我

forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness.” (1 John 1:8-9)

What are the ‘we’ in the passage? The receivers of this letter from John are those Born Again, not the opposite. John does not say ‘you’ but ‘we’, including himself. On the whole no-one would say old Apostle John has not been Born Again. He says, “If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves and the truth is not in us.” If those Born Again will not sin, what does it mean? Afterwards he tells us a way to be purified, “He is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness.” Here John says that we know we are sinful, but not necessary desperate nor frightened, only if we confess our sins, we will be pardoned and purified. And from this verse we learn that one Born Again can sin by the way. Since those Born Again will sin, what they must do is to confess, to get pardon and cleansing. Let us read on:

们往下再读约翰所写的几句话：

「我小子们哪，我将这些话写给你们，是要叫你们不犯罪。若有人犯罪，在父那里我们有一位中保，就是那义者耶稣基督。祂为我们的罪作了挽回祭，不是单为我们的罪，也是为普天下人的罪。」

（约壹 2:1-2）这一段话也是写给已经得了重生的人的。约翰说他写这话给他们是要叫他们不犯罪。既需要写这话给他们，叫他们不犯罪，可见他们是能犯罪的。正因为他们能犯罪，所以用得着约翰写这话给他们，帮助他们，提醒他们，叫他们不犯罪。但不幸有人犯了罪将怎样呢？约翰往下说甚么呢？他说「若有人犯罪，就显明这人不是属神的，这人未曾得着重生」么？或说「若有人犯罪，他就是明知故犯，再不要指望得赦免」么？或说「若有人犯罪，神必要取消他得救的资格，除掉他所得儿子的名分」么？不是这样。约翰没有这样说。这些说法

“My dear children, I write this to you so that you will not sin. But if anybody does sin, we have an advocate with the Father — Jesus Christ, the Righteous One. He is the atoning sacrifice for our sins, and not only for ours but also for the sins of the whole world.” (1 John 2:1-2) This passage is written to those Born Again. John says he writes it to them so that they will not sin. Telling them not to sin in the letter suggests their possibility to sin. Since they might sin, it is necessary for John to write to them, to help and remind them not to sin. What will it be if one sins unfortunately? What does John go on to say? Does he say, “If anybody sins, he is definitely not of God. He has not yet Born Again.”? Or does he say, “If anybody sins, he does it deliberately, he is hopeless to be pardoned.”? No way, John does not say so. These are invented later. John says, “If anybody sins, we have an advocate with the Father — Jesus Christ, the Righteous One. He is the atoning sacrifice for our sins.”

是后来的人发明的。约翰所说的乃是：「若有人犯罪，在父那里我们有一位中保，就是那义者耶稣基督，祂为我们的罪作了挽回祭。」

啊，这是何等宝贵的话！这话是怎样能帮助那些被罪打伤的信徒？怎样能安慰他们，使他们不致绝望，不致灰心？如果神的每一个孩子都清楚记得这话，将要有多少无谓的痛苦、畏惧、忧愁、失望都被消除？将要有多少被罪打伤的信徒立时就得着医治？

但也许有人以为圣经中有这一段教训真是极不好的，他们想这段经文岂不要使许多信徒有恃无恐的犯起罪来。他们想我们应当极严厉的警戒信徒说，若是得了救的人再犯罪，他们就是将神的儿子重钉十字架，他们再没有得赦免的指望，这样方可以帮助信徒不敢犯罪。他们想如果讲得救的人犯了罪仍能蒙赦免，必要有许多信徒放胆去犯罪。那是何等可怕的事呢？

Oh, what precious Words! How are they helpful for those sin bruising believers, comforting them not to be desperate and down hearted? If every child of God has the Words clearly in mind, there will be no more unnecessary agony, fear, worry and despair, and so many sin bruising believers will be healed.

But many think that the teaching of this passage is really bad, they think many believers will sin, with nothing to fear, because of this passage. They think that we should warn believers strictly, sinning after conversion is to nail the Son of God on the cross again, they are hopeless to be saved, this warning helps believers fear to sin. Telling that the sins of those saved can be pardoned, they think, must lead to a very horrible result of many believers' sinning without fear.

上面所说的这种思想是由于不明白圣经的道理而发生的。若是一个信徒真明白重生的道理，而且他自己也有过跟随主的经验，他必不会说这种话，也决不再有这种顾虑，他不但不能说这一段经文有害，他正要因着这一段经文感谢神，赞美神了。

比方说我有一次住在一位朋友家中，一天早晨我用剃刀刮脸的时候失手将脸割破了一块。那一位朋友家中本来备有许多医药用品，他一看见我割破了脸，便立刻拿一瓶创伤药，取出一些来涂在我的伤处，并且他将一瓶创伤药送给我，又告诉我无论甚么时候割破了脸，或是割伤了手，都可以随时涂一些在伤处，免得有甚么毒物从伤口进去，以致染毒，发生危险。我的朋友又许诺我，甚么时候用完这一瓶药，他还要再送给我。我因为得了这样有用的东西可以避免受伤中毒的危险，便十分感谢我的朋友。以后我回到自己屋里打开这个瓶子一看，其

This thought comes from the misunderstanding of the Bible. The believer, who realizes what Born Again is and has experience of following the Lord, will not say so, does not have such worry definitely. Not only will he not say the passage is dangerous, but also give thanks and praise God.

For instance, I called a friend once. One morning I cut my face with a razor carelessly. My friend had a stock of many medicines. When he saw this, he fetched a bottle of vulnerary, and spread some on my wound. He gave me the whole bottle, telling me how good it was for cutting wounds, the medicine spread was to avoid infection of the wound and other risk. My friend promised that he would give me some more when I ran out of the medicine. Receiving such useful good thing, I gave thanks to him. At home I opened the bottle and found that it allowed me to use tens of times. So I took the razor and cut my face left and right, cross and row, then spread the vulnerary on the wounds one by one. I cried, "Well,

中的药不少，我估计这瓶药总可以用个几十次，于是我便拿起刮脸的剃刀来，向脸的左边、右边，横着竖着连割了好几刀，以后再取些药出来照着伤口的数目一一涂上。我喊叫说：「现在好了，我有创伤药了。我可以时常割破我的脸，我的手也无所顾虑了！」请问如果我这样作起来，看见我的人要说我甚么呢？我知道他们一定要说我疯了。但我不会这样作，我决不会这样作。创伤药是有用处的好东西，我感谢着领受我的朋友们的馈赠，我要保存这瓶药，以备我失手割破皮肉的时候使用，但我决不肯因为有药的缘故就任意去割破我的皮肉。割破自己的皮肉自己要受伤害，要感痛苦，除非是神经有病的人，试问谁肯这样作呢？

约壹 2:1-2 的话正像神给祂的孩子们的一瓶创伤药。祂看见他们有时因不留意以致受伤——犯罪，祂恐怕他们因受伤而染毒——失望跌倒，所以给他们

I've got the vulnerary, I do not need to care about cutting my faces or hands anymore." What will those, who saw what I did, say? I know they will say I was crazy. I won't do that, never. The vulnerary I received gratefully from my friend is good and useful. I keep it and use it in case I cut myself. I would not cut myself willfully just because I get the medicine. Cutting oneself brings wounds and pain, so other than those crazy, who will try to do this?

The Words 1 John 2:1-2 is just like the vulnerary God giving to His children. He sees that they sometimes sin, hurt themselves carelessly, He gives them the vulnerary, so that the wounds with

这瓶药，叫他们在受伤的时快拿来涂上。创伤药是为人失手割破皮肉的时候用的，但没有人因为有了药便任意割破自己的皮肉，因为割破自己的皮肉自己要感受痛苦的。神给祂的孩子们的这一段恩惠的言语是为信徒软弱犯罪的时候用的，但没有信徒因为有了这段恩惠的言语便去任意犯罪，因为犯罪在一个得了重生的信徒身上是最痛苦的事，比一个人割破了他的皮肉还要痛苦许多倍。我要将这瓶属灵的创伤药介绍给一切信主的人，我不怕他们因为听了这段教训去犯罪，因我知道真得了重生的人一定不肯故意犯罪。或者有一些并未真实悔改信主，并未得着重生的教友（注意我称他们为教友，却不称他们为基督徒），因为听了这一段经训就有恃无恐的去犯罪，但这并不足顾虑，因为没有得重生的人无论如何总是喜欢犯罪，就是没有这段经文，他们所犯的罪又何尝少一些呢。神的应许是为祂的孩

medicine applied will not be infected, they will not fail on despair. The vulnerary is to be used when a wound is made carelessly. No-one would cut oneself deliberately due to possessing the medicine. Cutting oneself suffers. These gracious Words given by God are for those weak believers in case they sin. No believer will sin willfully just because they possess this gracious passage. The sinning of a Born Again believer is most painful, much more than the pain of cutting oneself. I would like to introduce this vulnerary to every believer, I am not afraid that they sin after learning the truth, for I know that those Born Again will not sin willfully. Maybe some false believers and non-Born Again Church goers (not Christians) will fear nothing and sin. It is futile, those non-Born Again like to sin anyway. They will not sin less without this passage. God's promises are for His (already Born Again) children, those un-Born Again false believers apply the Words of God indiscriminately, it is not what we can prohibit.

子们（已得重生的人）预备的，未曾得重生的假信徒若去妄用神的话，那就不是我们所能禁止的了。

一个信徒犯了罪，正如一个人受了伤一样。人都不愿意受伤，然而人都免不了受伤。我们应当嘱咐我们的小孩子小心自己不要受伤，同时我们也当为他们预备治疗创伤的药品，使他们在偶然受伤的时候不至惊惶失措。我们可以将受伤的痛苦和危险告诉他们，使他们因此怀着戒心，谨慎自己，免得受伤。但我们万不可告诉他们说，人一受伤就立刻会因伤而死。如果我们以为必须这样警戒我们的学生、孩子，他们才不敢伤害自己，那样有一日他们偶然受了一些伤，那种伤不致危及性命，但小孩子因惊恐过度却已吓得患了神经病，成了废人。那是何等愚昧的办法呢！

真得了重生的人都不愿意犯罪，然而人们却难免犯罪。我们那位满有智慧又慈爱的天父，一方面在圣经上警戒我们不要犯

Sinning of a believer is like injury of a man. No-one likes injury. But injury is not avoidable. We should bid our children to avoid injury, at the same time we would prepare them vulnerary, so they will not be panic when injured accidentally. We can tell them of the pain and risk of injury, to make them alert and take good care to avoid injury. But we must not tell them that injury causes death immediately. If we think that we must do so in order to make our students and children dare not hurt themselves, when a little one comes across an injury not endangering life, but becomes mental disorder and disabled due to excessive fear, what a really stupid method it is!

One truly Born Again does not will to sin, although sinning is unavoidable. Our wise and lovely Father in one way warns us in the Bible not to sin, shows us the

罪，将犯罪的害处都指示我们，一方面又为我们预备了一些救急的药品，使我们在偶然犯罪的时候可以应用，免得我们陷入更大的危险中。可怜许多无知的信徒不知道从哪里听来一种道理，竟说信徒得了重生以后如果犯罪必定再不能被赦免，连他们所得的救恩与生命也要失去。其实犯罪的害处本来还没有这样大（自然犯罪是有许多害处的），这种错误的道理却把那些偶然犯罪的信徒吓得心灵患了重病，有的经过多日才得痊愈，有的一生差不多成了废人。这是何等可惜的事呢？

现在我们离开约翰壹书，来读哥林多前书中的几段话：

「奉神旨意，蒙召作耶稣基督使徒的保罗，同兄弟所提尼，写信给在哥林多神的教会，就是在基督耶稣里成圣，蒙召作圣徒的，以及所有在各处求告我主耶稣基督之名的人。基督是他们的主，也是我们的主。」（林前 1:1-2）

harmful results, in another way He prepares us some first-aid cure to be used when we sin accidentally, to avoid a bigger risk. Alas, so many foolish believers listen to a theory from no-where, and believe that the sin of a Born Again believer is not pardonable, and they will lose the salvation and life they have. In fact the harmfulness of sinning is not so serious, although sinning brings harmfulness, the misapprehension makes those who sin accidentally crazy in spirit, it takes time to be healed. Some become a wreck all their lives. What a pity it is!

Let us go from the first letter of John to the first letter to the Corinthians.

“Paul, called to be an Apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and our brother Sosthenes, to the Church of God in Corinth, to those sanctified in Christ Jesus and called to be holy, together with all those everywhere who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ — their Lord and ours.” (1 Corinthians

「你们仍是属肉体的，因为在你们中间有嫉妒、纷争，这岂不是属乎肉体，照着世人的样子行么？」(林前 3:3)

「风闻在你们中间有淫乱的事。这样的淫乱连外邦人中也没有，就是有人收了他的继母。你们还是自高自大，并不哀痛，把行这事的人从你们中间赶出去。」(林前 5:1-2)

「你们中间有彼此相争的事，怎敢在不义的人面前求审，不在圣徒面前求审呢？.....你们竟是弟兄与弟兄告状，而且告在不信主的人面前。你们彼此告状，这已经是你们的大错了。为甚么不情愿受欺呢？为甚么不情愿吃亏呢？你们倒是欺压人，亏负人，况且所欺压所亏负的就是弟兄。」(林前 6:1；6-8)

「人应当自己省察，然后吃这饼，喝这杯。因

1:1-2)

“You are still worldly. For since there is jealousy and quarrelling among you, are you not worldly? Are you not acting like mere men?” (1 Corinthians 3:3)

“It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and of a kind that does not occur even among pagans: A man has his father’s wife. And you are proud! Shouldn’t you rather have been filled with grief and have put out of your fellowship the man who did this?” (1 Corinthians 5:1-2)

“If any of you has a dispute with another, dare he take it before the ungodly for judgment instead of before the saints? ... But instead, one brother goes to law against another — and this in front of unbelievers! The very fact that you have lawsuits among you means you have been completely defeated already. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be cheated? Instead, you yourselves cheat and do wrong, and you do this to your brothers.” (1 Corinthians 6:1, 6-8)

“A man ought to examine himself before he eats of the bread

为人吃喝，若不分辨是主的身体，就是吃喝自己的罪了。因此，在你们中间有好些软弱的与患病的，睡的也不少。」(林前 11:28-30)

请问哥林多的信徒是不是得了重生的人呢？在这封信的起始保罗称他们为「在基督耶稣里成圣蒙召作圣徒」的。我们能说在基督耶稣里成圣的人还未曾得重生么？未曾得重生的人能称为「圣徒」么？从保罗所写的话中可以看出清楚哥林多的信徒确是得了重生的人。但在这一封书信里，我们看见在这些信徒中曾见「嫉妒纷争」、「淫乱的事」、「彼此相争」、「弟兄与弟兄告状，而且告在不信的人面前」、「欺压人，亏负人」、「吃喝自己的罪」等等的事，这些明显的事实清清楚楚的告诉我们得了重生的人还能犯罪，而且有时还能犯很大的罪。

容我们再读另外一封信里的几段话：

and drinks of the cup. For anyone who eats and drinks without recognizing the body of the Lord eats and drinks judgment on himself. That is why many among you are weak and sick, and a number of you have fallen asleep.” (1 Corinthians 11:28-30)

Are the believers in Corinthian Born Again? In the start of the letter Paul addressed them as ‘sanctified in Christ Jesus and called to be holy’. Can we say that those sanctified in Christ Jesus have not yet Born Again, or those not yet Born Again as saints? From Paul’s words we are sure that those Corinthian believers are Born Again. But in other part of the letter we learn that among these believers we can find jealousy and quarrelling, adultery, dispute; one brother goes to law against another in front of unbelievers; cheats and does wrong, eats and drinks judgment on himself and etc. All these tells us an explicit fact that those Born Again can still sin, and even very serious.

Let us go to some other passages of another Epistle:

「奉神旨意，作基督耶稣使徒的保罗，写信给在以弗所的圣徒，就是在基督耶稣里有忠心的人。」
(弗 1:1)

「所以，你们要弃绝谎言，各人与邻舍说实话，因为我们是互相为肢体。生气却不要犯罪，不可含怒到日落，也不可给魔鬼留地步。从前偷窃的，不要再偷，总要劳力，亲手作正经事，就可有余分给那缺少的人。污秽的言语一句不可出口，只要随事说造就人的好话，叫听见的人得益处。不要叫神的圣灵担忧，你们原是受了祂的印记，等候得赎的日子来到。一切苦毒、恼恨、愤怒、嚷闹、毁谤，并一切的恶毒，都当从你们中间除掉，并要以恩慈相待，存怜悯的心，彼此饶恕，正如神在基督里饶恕了你们一样。」(弗 4:25-32)

“Paul, an Apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, to the saints in Ephesus, the faithful in Christ Jesus.” (Ephesians 1:1)

“Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbour, for we are all members of one body. In your anger do not sin. Do not let the sun go down while you are still angry, and do not give the Devil a foothold. He who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work, doing something useful with his own hands, that he may have something to share with those in need. Do not let any unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building others up according to their needs, that it may benefit those who listen. And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, with whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. Get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, brawling and slander, along with every form of malice. Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you.” (Ephesians 4:25-32)

保罗称以弗所信徒为圣徒，为基督耶稣里有忠心的人，足证这些人不但已经得了重生，而且他们属灵的程度还很高。就是对这些人保罗写了上文所引的一大段教训。他劝他们「要弃绝谎言，各人与邻舍说实话」，「生气却不要犯罪」，「不可给魔鬼留地步」，「不要再偷」，「污秽的言语一句不可出口」，「不要叫神的圣灵担忧」。他又劝他们除掉「一切苦毒、恼恨、愤怒、嚷闹、毁谤，并一切的恶毒」。如果得了重生的人不能犯罪，保罗写这一大段教训不是完全没有意思了么？我们不用劝诫一个哑巴儿童说：「不要说谎，不要骂人。」因为哑巴不会说话，他不能说谎，也不能骂人。我们也不用劝诫一个瞎眼的人说：「不要看淫秽的小说和引人犯罪的电影。」因为瞎子甚么都看不见，根本不能看小说和电影。如果得了重生的人不能犯罪，保罗写这一大段教训不是和教训哑巴不要说谎，骂人，教训瞎子

Paul addressed the Ephesians as 'saints, the faithful in Christ Jesus'. It is sufficient to prove that they were Born Again, and having a high spiritual standard too. Paul wrote the long passage of lesson, persuaded them to put off falsehood and speak truthfully to their neighbour, not to sin in their anger, not to give the Devil a foothold, steal no longer, not to let any unwholesome talk come out of their mouths, not to grieve the Holy Spirit of God, get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, brawling and slander. If those Born Again would not sin, the long passage Paul wrote would be meaningless. We will not persuade a dumb boy not to lie nor scold, since a dumb cannot speak, he cannot lie nor scold. We will not exhort a blind not to read obscene novels and crime inducing films, since the blind cannot see, they will not encounter novels and films. If those Born Again would not sin, what Paul wrote is as meaningless as to teach the dumb not to lie and scold, and to teach the blind not to encounter immoral films and novels.

不要看诲淫的电影、小说一样的毫无意义了么？

岂单是在以弗所书中有这一类的教训呢？在别卷书信里不也有许多这一类教训么？使徒所写的书信没有一封是写给不信的人的。如果得了重生的人不能犯罪，这些教训不都成了毫无意思的「废话」了么？不用说普通的信徒，提摩太是保罗所倚重的同工，保罗称他为爱的儿子，就是这样的一位圣洁忠心的神仆，保罗还是教训他「逃避少年的私欲，同那清心祷告主的人追求公义、信德、仁爱、和平。」（提后 2:22）若是提摩太还须要「逃避少年的私欲」，得了重生的人还能犯罪的真理，不是更加显明了么？

容我们现在再看一段保罗自己的经验：

「我们原晓得律法是属乎灵的，但我是属乎肉体的，是已经卖给罪了。因为我所作的，我自己不明白，我所愿意的，我并不作，我所恨恶的，我倒

Not only there in the Epistle to Ephesians is such teaching, we can also find them in other Epistles. All the letters of the Apostles were to believers. If those Born Again will not sin, all these will become meaningless rubbish. Not only ordinary believers, Timothy, Paul's important partner, being addressed as the beloved son, such a holy faithful servant of God, to him Paul advised him "So flee youthful passions and pursue righteousness, faith, love, and peace, along with those who call on the Lord from a pure heart." (2 Timothy 2:22) Even Timothy needs to flee youthful passions and pursue righteousness, then one Born Again will sin is nothing but an explicit truth.

Let us see Paul's own experience:

"We know that the law is spiritual; but I am unspiritual, sold as a slave to sin. I do not understand what I do. For what I want to do I do not do, but what I hate I do. And if I do what I do not

去作。若我所作的，是我所不愿意的，我就应承律法是善的。既是这样，就不是我作的，乃是住在我里头的罪作的。我也知道在我里头，就是在我肉体之中，没有良善。因为立志为善由得我，只是行出来由不得我。故此，我所愿意的善，我反不作；我所不愿意的恶，我倒去作。若我若我去作所不愿意作的，就不是我作的，乃是住在我里头的罪作的。我觉得有个律，就是我愿意为善的时候，便有恶与我同在。因为按着我里面的人，我是喜欢神的律，但我觉得肢体中另有个律和我心中的律交战，把我掳去，叫我附从那肢体中犯罪的律。我真是苦啊！谁能救我脱离这取死的身体呢？」(罗 7:14-24)

无疑的，保罗这一段话是述说他重生以后所经过的一种战争的经验。他已经得了重生，他里面有一个新人。那个由神而生的里面的人喜欢神的律。「因为按着我里面的人，

want to do, I agree that the law is good. As it is, it is no longer I myself who do it, but it is sin living in me. For I know that good itself does not dwell in me, that is, in my sinful nature. For I have the desire to do what is good, but I cannot carry it out. For I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do — this I keep on doing. Now if I do what I do not want to do, it is no longer I who do it, but it is sin living in me that does it. So I find this law at work: Although I want to do good, evil is right there with me. For in my inner being I delight in God's law; but I see another law at work in me, waging war against the law of my mind and making me a prisoner of the law of sin at work within me. What a wretched man I am! Who will rescue me from this body that is subject to death?" (Romans 7:14-24)

Certainly Paul here is talking about the struggling experience after being Born Again. He has been Born Again, he has an inward man, God gave birth, who delights in the law of God. For in his inner being he delights in God's law. But

我是喜欢神的律。」但他「觉得肢体中另有个律」和他「心中的律交战，把他掳去」，叫他「附从那肢体中犯罪的律」。他陷在一种非常苦痛的境况中，这种境况是他在未得重生以前所未曾经历过的。他定意为善，但是竟做不到；他决心离弃恶事，但他竟离弃不了；他不愿意随从那肢体中犯罪的律，但他竟被它掳去。他失去了自由，他感到不可名状的苦痛和失望，以致他呼喊说：「我真是苦啊！谁能救我脱离这取死的身體呢？」多少真实得了重生的信徒都能从心中回应保罗所说这段话。他们经验过这种战争，遭遇过这种失败，感受过这种痛苦。他们中间也有许多人因为不明白这是新旧人的交战，竟误以为自己未得重生，所以才有这种苦况，如果再有人教训他们说得了重生的人必不能犯罪，他们更要想自己是未曾得重生了。其实这种经验正是一个证据证明一个人得了重生。未得重生的人不

he sees another law at work in him, waging war against the law of his mind and making him a prisoner of the law of sin at work within him. He falls into an extremely painful situation he has never come across before being Born Again. He determines to do good but fails; he resolves to abandon the evil things but fails too. He does not want to follow the law of sin inside, but he is captured. Losing his freedom, he feels painful and desperate beyond description, so he cries loudly, "Who will rescue me from this body that is subject to death?" Many truly Born Again believers say yes in respond to what Paul says. They come across the battle, the loss and the agony. Among them many do not realize the battle between the old and the new, misinterpret the painful situation as not yet Born Again. When they are taught that one Born Again will not sin, they regard themselves as not yet Born Again more certainly. In fact this experience does prove that one is Born Again. One not yet Born Again does not desire the law of God, the law of sin will not capture him,

喜欢神的律，罪的律也不会掳他，因为他根本是完全服在罪的权下。每一个得了重生的人都有过这种战争的经验。有许多得了重生的人也长久含辛茹苦地在这种苦况中度生活。这种苦况是得了重生的人必定经历过的，然而他们不当长久在这种苦况当中生活。圣灵在圣徒身上的工作，就是要使他们经过这种战争而得着一种胜利的生活，正如保罗在罗马书第八章里所描述的：

「赐生命圣灵的律，在基督耶稣里释放了我，使我脱离罪和死的律了。」(罗 8:2)

有一段经文常被人误解，被人引用作为得了重生的人不能犯罪的证据：

「犯罪的是属魔鬼，因为魔鬼从起初就犯罪。神的儿子显现出来，为要除灭魔鬼的作为。凡从神生的，就不犯罪，因神的种存在他心里，他也不能犯罪，因为他是由神生的。」(约壹 3:8-9)

since he is already under the power of sin. Every Born Again has come across this struggle. Many of them have lived in such panic situation for long. It is what those Born Again must have, but not necessarily stay there long. The Holy Spirit works in the saints to lead them come through the battle and have a victorious life, as what Paul says in Romans Chapter 8: "through Christ Jesus the law of the Spirit who gives life has set you free from the law of sin and death." (Romans 8:2)

A Bible passage is often misinterpreted and quoted, to prove that those Born Again will not sin.

"The one who does what is sinful is of the Devil, because the Devil has been sinning from the beginning. The reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the Devil's work. No-one who is born of God will continue to sin, because God's seed remains in them; they cannot go on sinning, because they

有些人引证这段经文说，这里不是明说「从神生的，就不犯罪」了么？不是又说「他也不能犯罪」么？那样这倒真希奇了！我们在上面所查的一切经训里，已经看见重生的人能犯罪，这里怎么又说不能呢？有些批评圣经的人又在那里振振有辞了。他们说：「啊，我们早就说圣经是不可信的，圣经中有许多彼此冲突、互相歧异的地方，这不是一个铁证么？不用说新约与旧约有许多彼此不合的地方，也不用说不同的两卷书中有许多互相矛盾的地方，就是在同一卷书中，就有这样彼此冲突的说法。约翰壹书第一、二章中明说了重生的人还能犯罪，第三章中又说『从神生的就不犯罪，.....他也不能犯罪。』这不是清清楚楚的显明圣经中有许多错误么？」不，圣经没有错误。若有错误，不是圣经本身的错误，乃是人弄出来的，或是译圣经的译错，或是

have been born of God.” (1 John 3:8-9)

Explicitly quoting the passages “No-one who is born of God will continue to sin” and “they cannot go on sinning”, some give querying expression, ‘From what we study above we learn that those Born Again can sin, how does here say they cannot?’ Some Bible critics assert eloquently, “Isn’t it an indubitable evidence that the Bible is not trustworthy, since there are many conflicts and diverging opinions?” It is true that there are indifferent examples between Old and New Testaments, or between books, even in the same book there are conflicts. The first two chapters of the First Epistle of John teach clearly that one Born Again can sin, while in chapter 3 it writes “No-one who is born of God will continue to sin.” and “they cannot go on sinning.” Do they prove clearly that there are mistakes in the Bible? No, there are no mistakes. If there are, they are not of the Bible, but of men, of wrong translation, of wrong interpretation. Misinterpretation of 1 John 3:8-9 makes us say there are

解圣经的人解错，若是我们误解了约壹 3:8-9 的意思，我们就难免说这两节的话与别的经文互相冲突了。但我们若明白了这两节的真义，就晓得这两节与其它各段实在仍是相合不悖的了。

「凡从神生的，就不犯罪」，「他也不能犯罪」，这是千真万确的真理。神不犯罪，所以神所生的人也不犯罪。我笃信这事没有疑惑，但我们要问神所生的人是甚么样式？我们这个看得见的外面的人是不是神所生的呢？自然不是。这个外面看得见的人是父母生的，是从肉身生的。「从肉身生的就是肉身，从灵生的就是灵。」一个人得了重生以后，他里面有了一个新人，这个人是被神所生的，是像神的，是有神的性情的，这个人是不犯罪，也不能犯罪，因为他是由神生的。但那个外面的人却是从肉身生的，是能犯罪的，也是倾向罪的。一个人得了重生以后，那外面的人并未曾死去，乃是仍然存在那里，

conflicts. Realizing the original meaning will make us know that there is no inconformity.

“No-one who is born of God will continue to sin” and “they cannot go on sinning” are absolutely true. God does not sin, so those born of God do not sin. I adhere to it beyond doubt. We have to ask what likeness does one born of God have? Is it the visible outward man born of God? Of course not. This visible outward man is born of parents, of flesh. “That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of Spirit is spirit.” One being Born Again has a new inner life. He is born of God, he is like God, with the disposition of God. This man does not and cannot sin, because he is born of God. However the outward man, born of flesh, can sin and is apt to sin. When one is Born Again, the outward man has not yet died, he is still there, what is different is that there is a man

不过他里面却多了一个被神所生的「里面的人」。两个性情相反的人住在一处真是一件不幸的事。他们常常惹起争端，常常吵闹，这就是保罗所说：「因为按着我里面的人，我是喜欢神的律，但我觉得肢体中另有个律和我心中的律交战，把我掳去，叫我附从那肢体中犯罪的律。」一个得了重生的人是有两个人的，一个是外面的，一个是里面的。外面的人是从肉身生的，是污秽的、喜爱犯罪的；里面的人是从圣灵生的，是圣洁的、恨恶罪的。正是因为这个缘故，许多得了重生的人常感到保罗在罗马书第七章所说的那种困难：「立志为善由得我，只是行出来由不得我，故此，我所愿意的善，我反不作，我所不愿意的恶，我倒去作。」

许多实在得了重生的人因为不明白这个极大的真理，便陷在一种怀疑失望的苦境里。他们在悔改信主的时候，是那样的为罪忧伤痛悔，是那样破釜

more, the inward man born of God. It is a pity that two men with opposite dispositions live together. They are always in conflict and quarrel, so that is what Paul says, "For in my inner being I delight in God's law; but I see another law at work in me, waging war against the law of my mind and making me a prisoner of the law of sin at work within me." One Born Again has two lives, an outward man and an inward man. The outward one is born of flesh, filthy and desires to sin; the inward one is born of Spirit, holy and hates to sin. As a result, many Born Again always share the same difficulty Paul encountered as read in Romans 7, "For I have the desire to do what is good, but I cannot carry it out. For I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do — this I keep on doing." (Romans 7:18-19)

Many true Born Again do not recognize this significant truth and fall into a situation of doubt and desperation. When they were converted, they mourned and felt sorry for sin. They determined

沉舟的定志要永远与罪断绝关系。他们想自己既然得了重生，有了新生命，并且又立定这样坚决的心志，从此一定可以完全脱离罪的束缚，作一个自由自在、圣洁无疵的人了。谁想到过了不多时竟遇着这样剧烈的战争，而且屡屡的遭遇异常苦痛的失败，这时他们真好似陷在五里雾中。他们心想，若说自己未曾重生呢，却清清楚楚的有悔改得救的经验；若说自己得了重生呢，怎么现在竟会有这种剧烈的战争，而且又遭遇这种苦痛的失败呢？当他们陷在这种苦境中的时候，极容易受撒但的攻击，或是失去信心，或是跌倒退后。只有真理的光能帮助他们看明白这究竟是怎么一回事。

我们若明白这新人与旧人交战的事，便晓得信徒有这种剧烈的战争不但不足以证明他们未得重生，反倒证明他实在是得了重生。他们遭遇苦痛的失败就是因为他们那「里面的人」力量微弱，不足

resolutely to depart from sin forever. They thought that they were Born Again, getting the new life. They then strongly made up their mind to be divorced from the bond of sin, to become free, holy and blameless. Who knows a fierce battle came so soon, and they suffered from bitter misery and failure bewilderingly. If they had been Born Again, why was it that there came the fierce battle, suffering from misery and failure? When they panic, they are easily attacked by Satan, losing their faith, tumbling and turning back. Only the light of the Truth can help them to see what the matter is.

Realizing the battle between the new man and the old man, we know that the fierce battle does not prove that they are not Born Again, but the opposite. They came across the panic of failure because the inward man was weak, not strong enough to win

胜过那「外面的人」。他们已经得了重生，不该再怀疑到重生的事，他们现在所须要的就是求神「按着祂丰盛的荣耀，藉着祂的灵」，叫他们「里面的人刚强起来」(弗 3:16)。如果他们那「里面的人」能刚强起来，制服他们「外面的人」，他们便能过着一种圣洁得胜的生活了。或有人说，得了重生的人既然也能犯罪，并且有时还能屡次陷在罪中不能自拔，那样他们与未得重生的人不是完全一样了么？我要回答这问题说，不是的。未得重生的人与得了重生的人固然都能犯罪，但他们对于罪的态度和犯罪以后的感觉却是完全两样。未得重生的人不但犯罪，而且喜爱犯罪。他们活在罪中非但不感觉痛苦，反倒引为幸事，他们愿意活在罪里。得了重生的人也犯罪，但他们却恨恶罪。他们不愿意犯罪，但他们却难免陷在罪中。当他们陷在罪里的时候，他们感觉到一种不可名状的痛苦。他们巴不得立时有人

against the outward man. Doubtlessly they have been Born Again. What they must do now is to ask God out of His glorious riches to strengthen them with power through His Spirit in their inner beings. (Ephesians 3:16) If their inward man becomes strong and subdues the outward man, they lead a life of holiness and victory. Some may ask that if the one Born Again can sin, even often get lost in sins, then are they no different from those not Born Again? My answer is no. Both of them can sin, but the attitude to sin and the feeling after sinning are completely different. Those not Born Again not only sin, they desire to sin also. They, living in sin, are not panicked, but take pleasure in it, willing to live in sin. Those Born Again hate sin and do not will to sin, however they fall into sin unavoidably. In sin, they felt painful beyond description. They are too anxious to have someone pull them out of sin. They cry loudly, "What a wretched man I am! Who will rescue me from this body that is subject to death?"

将他们从罪中救拔出来。他们喊着说：「我真是苦啊！谁能救我脱离这取死的身體呢？」

大约我们都看见过羊与猪这两种家畜吧。这两种家畜中间有一种极显见的分别——前者喜爱洁净，后者喜爱污秽。因为羊的性情喜爱洁净，所以牠们愿意住在洁净的地方，吃洁净的食物，喝洁净的水。因为猪的性情喜爱污秽，所以牠们愿意住在污秽的地方，吃污秽的食物，喝污秽的水。羊固然是喜爱洁净的，但牠们如果不谨慎，也难免落在猪所喜欢居住的泥坑中，以致弄得全身都是污泥，看见牠们的人若不仔细分辨，也许会拿牠们当作了猪。虽然这样，羊总是羊，我们决不能因为看见牠们落在泥坑中，弄得满身是泥，便说牠们是猪，因为牠们虽然落在泥里，但是牠们并不喜欢在那个地方，牠们虽然弄得满身是泥，但是牠们并不愿意这样。当牠们落在泥坑中的时候，牠们感到一种深切的痛苦，

We mostly know sheep and swine. There is a very obvious difference between these two livestock. The former like cleanliness, the latter like filthiness. Sheep like cleanliness in nature, and willing to live in clean places, eat clean food and drink clean water. However swine are filthy in nature, and willing to live in filthy places, eat filthy food and drink filthy water. No doubt sheep like cleanliness, but they will fall carelessly into the mud pit the swine abide in, having mud all over, careless people may mistake them as swine. In spite of this, sheep are sheep. We cannot say the sheep in a pit with mud all over are definitely swine. Although they are in the mud, it is still the place they do not like. Although mud is all over, it is still not of their will. When they fall in the mud pit, they are deeply panicked, and reverberate to be saved. However swine are different. They like the mud pit, and go around for it. Once

牠们发出求救的呼声来，巴不得有甚么人快来，将牠们从这种污浊困苦淤泥坑中救拔出来。猪却不是这样了，牠们喜欢在泥坑里，因此牠们四处寻找泥坑，及至遇见这种污秽的地方，便立刻跑到里面去，在那种臭不可闻的泥水里找些污秽的东西，吃下去，喝下去，满足牠们那种喜爱污秽的欲望。牠们在那种污秽的地方不但不呼求人的救助，反得意洋洋。若有人想要将牠们从泥坑里救拔出来，牠们倒要恨恶那人，用牠们的利齿咬伤那人的手。得了重生的人与未得重生的人所有的大分别就是这个。一个得了重生的人好像一只羊，他有神的性情，所以他喜欢洁净，不过，他住在这样一个处处都是泥坑、陷阱的罪恶世界中，稍有不慎，便会落到罪恶的泥坑里，沾染上一些罪恶。但一个得了重生的人落在罪恶里正像一只羊落在泥坑里一般，他会感到不可名状的痛苦，不住地从里面发出求救的呼声，

it is found, they run into it. In the muddy water of unbearable stink they search for filthy things to eat and drink, satisfying their desire for filthiness. In a filthy place like this they will not ask for help, but are filled with elation. If someone tries to pull them out, they hate him, and bite his hand with their sharp teeth. The big difference between one Born Again and one not yet Born Again is that, one Born Again is like a sheep, having God's character, he likes being clean, but he lives in an evil world with mud pits and traps around. Slight carelessness makes him fall into the evil mud pit and contaminate with some sins. One Born Again falling in sin is like a sheep in a mud pit, what he feels is indescribable agonizing, calling for help, he longs to get out and be saved. One not yet Born Again is not like that, he seeks opportunities to sin, finding pleasure in it. Being sinful, he is like a happy swine in a mud pit. If some compassionate one tries to save him out of sin, he is not only unwilling to be helped, but also regards it a malice, and shame, harmful to his interest and fame.

他渴望从罪恶中得着释放和解救。一个未得重生的人就不是这样。他寻找机会去犯罪，以犯罪为乐。他在罪恶中正像一只猪在泥坑里一般的得意，如果有人哀怜他，设法救他脱离罪恶，他不但不乐意受那人的帮助，反倒以为那人要害他，是要羞辱他，是要损害他的利益和名誉，因此怒目相向，与那人为敌。这种情形我们不是屡次的看见么？

我在不明白这些真理的时候，以为凡品行好的基督徒才是基督徒，品行不好的就是假基督徒，现在我才明白这种判断有时是对的。品行不好的基督徒诚然有许多果真是假的，然而其中也有一些正像落在泥坑中的羊，陷在罪里，但是不愿意在那里。他们犯了罪是我们看见的，我们却未曾看见他们是怎样的感到痛苦不安，其实他们为此不知道落过多少滴眼泪，发过多少次叹声。他们尽力挣扎，要想脱离罪恶的束缚。他们几次的胜利我们未曾注

So usually the response found is being gazed upon with animosity and hostility.

Before I realized this truth, I thought only good Christians were real Christians, bad ones were fake, until now I know this kind of judgment is not always right. Many Christians without good conduct indeed are fake, but among them some are sheep in mud pit, falling in sin unwillingly. We see that they are sinful, but we may not see how panic and restless they feel. They shed so many tears and heave so many sighs. They strive hard to escape from evil bonds. No victory but failure has been seen, so we say that they are fake Christians, not yet Born Again. What an injustice they have! Are we correct

意，但他们几次的失败却都被我们看见，因此我们便说他们是假基督徒，是未得重生的。请想他们冤屈到了甚么地步！请问我们这种武断是不是合理呢？

察验一个人是否得了重生，不要只看他是否犯罪，更要紧的是看他对罪的态度如何。得了重生的人能犯罪，然而他们断不能喜爱犯罪。未得重生的人不但能犯罪，而且喜爱犯罪。这就是这两种人中间最大的一个分别。

不引领人到基督面前使他悔改信主得着重生，只去改良一下他的环境，帮助他去掉一些外面的坏习惯嗜好，盼望他从此以后，可以作好人不再犯罪，这正像把一只猪从泥坑里拉出来，为牠用净水洗浴，然后预备一间清洁的屋子，叫牠住在里面一样。当这只猪住在这间清洁的屋子里的时候，牠的外面实在变清洁了。但有一日看守的人忘记将门关好，这只猪便立时逃出去，一直跑回牠从前所躺卧的泥

to be so arbitrary?

To judge one Born Again or not, don't just see if he sins, more important is to see his attitude to sin. Those Born Again can sin, but they don't desire to sin at all. Those not Born Again not only sin, they like it. This is the most distinctive difference.

Not leading someone to repent, to believe in Christ or to be Born Again, just changing his environment, helping him to get rid of some external bad habits and interests, hoping that he will be good, no more sinning henceforth, it is as if pulling a swine out of a mud pit and having it cleansed, preparing for it a clean house to stay in. When the swine lives in the clean house, it looks externally clean. However, it will escape. When the door keeper forgets to lock the door, it will run to the mud pit it sprawled in before, resume

坑中，恢复了牠从前的污秽生活。里面的性情没有改变，只改变一些外面的事，是没有多少益处的。现在许多传道的人，所讲的那种「改良社会，提高人格」的道理就是为猪洗澡的办法。这种办法永远不会收甚么真实的效果，惟有传扬基督耶稣的福音，指示人悔改得救的道路，帮助人信主得重生，才是彻底的办法。

得了重生的人仍能犯罪，不单是因为他们处在污秽邪恶的世界中，随时有试探和陷阱，也是因为他们里面有两个绝对相反的性情——一个是属地的，一个是属天的；一个是污秽邪恶的，一个是圣洁良善的；一个是在第一次生的时候得着的，一个是在第二次生的时候得着的。这两个性情也就是我们以前所说的两个人：外面的人和里面的人。外面的人强过里面的人，里面的人便被外面的人制胜；里面的人强过外面的人，外面

the filthy life it once had. The nature inside has not been changed, only changing the appearance is useless. Nowadays the teaching of "society reformation and character promotion" many preachers made are similar to that of swine cleansing. It does not yield fruitful result. Preaching the Gospel of Christ Jesus, showing the way of repentance and redemption, helping others to believe in Jesus and be Born Again, only this is the radical method.

One Born Again can still sin, not only because he lives in a filthy evil world. He will come across temptations and snares, and there are also two opposite natures inside, one of earth and one of heaven; one of filthy evil and one of holy good; one came of the first birth, the other the second. These two natures are the two men we mentioned before, the outward man and the inward man. When the outward man is stronger, the inward man will be overcome, and vice versa. When the inward man rules, the believer leads a holy, noble, happy and satisfied life;

的人便被里面的人克服。里面的人得胜掌权的时候，这个信徒就度着圣洁、高尚、快乐、满足的生活；外面的人得胜掌权的时候，这个信徒就度着污秽、堕落、痛苦、烦恼的生活。正是因为这个缘故，保罗写信给以弗所的教会说：「因此，我在父面前屈膝，（天上地上的各家，都是从祂得名。）求祂按着祂丰盛的荣耀，藉着祂的灵，叫你们心里的力量刚强起来。」（弗 3:14-16）这是保罗为教会所奉献的祷告，这也应当作为我们每个信徒在神面前所发的呼求。

属神的人在世界上生活的时候，常常遭遇三种仇敌的攻击。一个仇敌是他们的肉体，或说外面的人；一个仇敌是空中掌权的恶魔；还有一个仇敌就是这伏在撒但权下的世界，或说这污秽邪恶的社会。从人事一方面看起来，我们真是毫无得胜的指望。这三个仇敌中的一个就足能制服我们而有余，何况三个仇敌联合起来向我们进攻呢？这罪恶的世

when the outward man rules, the believer will have a filthy, immoral, panicking and worrying life. Hence Paul wrote to the Ephesians, saying, "For this reason I kneel before the Father, from whom every family in heaven and on earth derives its name. I pray that out of His glorious riches He may strengthen you with power through His Spirit in your inner being." (Ephesians 3:14-16) This is the prayer Paul offers for the Church, it should also be the prayer of every believer before God.

When those, of God, live in the world, they often meet attacks from three enemies. The first one is their flesh, or the outward man; the second is the Devil of the power of the air; the third is the world under the power of Satan, or the filthy evil society. From man's point of view, we do not have any hope of victory. Any one of them is strong enough to overcome us, let alone the attack of the union troop. The evil world compasses us on all sides. Satan attacks us from above,

界在我们四面包围着我们，撒但从中向我们进攻，我们的肉体在里面起来响应。这种情势拿现代战争来形容，正可以说四面被海陆军包围，空中又有飞机的轰炸，里面还加上第五部队的扰乱。可怜的基督徒！保守阵地尚且办不到，那里还提得到胜利呢？

感谢神，我们现在藉着祂的话，确实的知道我们虽然处在这种四面受敌的境况中，却仍有得胜的指望，因为我们的元帅基督已经战胜了一切的仇敌。祂永远活着，祂要扶助我们，增加我们的力量。祂要率领我们与那些凶猛的仇敌作战。我们靠着祂不但能得胜，而且能得胜有余。只要我们信祂，靠祂，亲近祂，听从祂的命令，我们必能看见祂的恩典是够我们用的，祂的能力是在我们的软弱上显得完全。那时我们必要像保罗那样说：「所以，我更喜欢夸自己的软弱，好叫基督的能力覆庇我。.....因我甚么时候软弱，甚么时

the flesh inside us rises and joins in. In modern military term, it may be said that we are encompassed by grand force on all sides, with plane bombardment above and invasion of the fifth column. Poor Christians! Keeping the defensive line is hardly possible, let alone mentioning victory!

Thanks be to God, with His Words we are certain that, although being troubled on every side, we still have hope of victory, since Christ our captain has conquered all enemies. He lives forever. He supports and strengthens us. He will lead us to fight the fierce enemy. We who trust in Him not only will conquer, but are more than conquerors. Only if we trust Him, cleave unto Him, come near unto Him, hearken unto Him, we will find His grace sufficient for us. His strength is made perfect in weakness. Then we will say like Paul, "Therefore I will boast all the more gladly about my weaknesses, so that Christ's power may rest on me. ... For when I am weak, then I am strong." (2

候就刚强了。」(林后 Corinthians 12:9-10)
12:9-10)

Born Again

重生真义

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《重生真义》

本书简绝大部分的属灵书都是英译中的，中译英的惟有这一本。

重生的方法只有一个，就是信耶稣。重生的重要在于只有重生才得见和得进神的国。重生是藉神的道和神的圣灵来生。重生的是里面的人。重生虽看不见，但重生的人会显露出一些特别的现象，他的心思、意志、愿望、生活、言语、行为都与以前大不相同，他的人生有了一种空前的改变。

一个因罪而丢失生命的罪人来信耶稣有四个步骤：一、一个罪人必须知道自己真是犯了罪；二、他必须知道犯罪的必要死亡；三、他必须知道他毫无方法可以救自己；四、他必须信神的话，仰望那挂在木头上的耶稣基督。

正如本书简第一部《鼓手男孩的祈祷》一样，这书想给与出席教会却仍未信主的人弄清如何得重生；同时也想帮助那些已得救却仍犯罪的信徒。

我们若明白这新人与旧人交战的事，便晓得信徒有这种剧烈的战争不但不足以证明他们未得重生，反倒证明他实在是得了重生。他们遭遇苦痛的失败就是因为他们那「里面的人」力量微弱，不足胜过那「外面的人」。他们现在所须要的就是求神「按着祂丰盛的荣耀，藉着祂的灵」，叫他们「里面的人刚强起来」(弗 3:16)。如果他们那「里面的人」能刚强起来，制服他们「外面的人」，他们便能过着一种圣洁得胜的生活了。

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